

ENGLISH FOR RECEIVING, STOCK, AND DISPATCH

Warehouse and Distribution English

Exact quantities. Clear status.

Phil Stilwell

© 2026 Phil Stilwell. All rights reserved.

No part of this publication may be reproduced, stored in a retrieval system, or transmitted in any form or by any means without prior written permission from the author, except as permitted by law.



Eight lessons. Eleven extended conversations.

INSIDE THE BOOK

192 vocabulary entries / 128 reusable phrases
220 extended-dialogue turns / 11 transfer exchanges
Word banks and explained answer keys

Upper-intermediate to advanced (B2-C1). For receiving clerks, pickers, packers, inventory staff, returns teams, and distribution supervisors.

2026 edition

Eight scenarios. Eight skills.

Eight warehouse conversations: flag an inbound overage, resolve conflicting item labels, confirm each-versus-case quantities, report a short pick, pause a label mismatch, reconcile a dispatch manifest, route a return review, and hand over a verified count difference.

01 Receiving against the expected shipment

4

Two cartons over the order | Report an inbound overage with matching item labels while preserving the original order and the limit of your authority.

02 Locating and identifying stock

13

The bin sign and stock disagree | Read back similar item codes, distinguish location labels from product labels, and request a record check without substituting stock.

03 Picking the right unit and quantity

22

Six each is not six cases | Resolve a unit-of-measure misunderstanding, calculate the product-specific case equivalent, and confirm the requested total.

04 Reporting a short pick and replenishment need

31

Reserve stock is not a delivery promise | Quantify a pick-face shortfall, distinguish system reserve stock from available stock, and escalate against a stated cutoff.

05 Packing and label discrepancies

40

The loose label belongs to another carton | Interrupt a possible labeling error politely, compare carton and recipient references, and distinguish prevention from a completed error.

06 Staging and dispatch status

49

Three staged, two on the manifest | Compare staged goods with a dispatch record and report a cutoff risk without claiming departure or an approved correction.

07 Returns and stock status

58

Unopened-looking is not ready for sale | Confirm return identity, qualify an external observation, and refer condition review without releasing the item as saleable.

08 Inventory and shift handoffs

67

The recount agrees, the cause does not | Transfer a verified count difference, distinguish completed recount from pending investigation, and preserve adjustment authority.

Communication field notes

3

Three more workplace conversations

76

Answers and explanations

85

Fast-access phrase pages

104

Vocabulary index

106

Sources and publication notes

114

The item, the unit, and the status.

Warehouse English connects physical goods to records without confusing the two. Useful messages identify the exact item and location, state quantities with their units, and make clear whether goods are merely present, available, approved, staged, or actually dispatched.

Keep the unit beside the number

Six each and six cases can describe very different quantities. Confirm the product-specific pack size before making a conversion; do not assume that all cartons or cases contain the same number.

"Six trays are requested; this item has six trays per case, so that is one case."

Read the item, not just the location

A bin sign can conflict with the label on the stock. Report both identifiers and the location rather than treating a familiar bin as proof that the product is correct.

"A12 is marked BK-14-B, but the stock label reads BK-14-G."

Separate presence from availability

Stock shown in reserve may be allocated or otherwise unavailable. Staged cartons may still be missing from dispatch records. Name the uncompleted check before promising a full order or a departure.

"Four are at the pick face; the twelve shown in reserve still need an availability check."

Distinguish a count from permission to change it

An agreed recount can establish an observed quantity without establishing the cause of a difference or authorizing an adjustment. Transfer the figures, completed checks, and next owner together.

"Both counts give eighteen; the system shows twenty. Sam owns the transaction review."

PROFESSIONAL BOUNDARIES

All orders, goods, locations, quantities, workers, times, and decisions are fictional. This book teaches workplace English, not equipment operation, manual handling, warehouse-system configuration, product-safety inspection, or inventory authorization. Follow actual site procedures, training, safety controls, product requirements, and approval limits. The dialogues do not authorize stock movement, relabeling, release for sale, shipment, or record adjustment. Do not enter restricted areas or operate equipment based on a language exercise.

Two cartons over the order

A Read the situation

Report an inbound overage with matching item labels while preserving the original order and the limit of your authority.

Receiving clerk Nia checks a shipment against purchase order 740, which expects twenty cartons. The physical count is twenty-two cartons, and the item labels match the ordered item. The supplier has not explained the additional two cartons. Nia can flag the overage to inventory coordinator Ben, but neither can treat this conversation as approval to change the order. Matching item labels do not settle quantity acceptance, payment, stock release, or the cause of the difference.

PEOPLE / Nia: Receiving clerk | Ben: Inventory coordinator

A MATCHING ITEM CAN STILL HAVE A QUANTITY EXCEPTION

Positive wording such as the labels match is useful, but it must not conceal an overage. Give the expected and observed counts in one message. Report what needs review without making the record agree by quietly changing the order quantity.

Briefing checks

Circle one answer in each item. Use the briefing.

1. What does purchase order 740 expect?

A Two cartons

C Twenty cartons

B Twenty individual products

D Twenty-two cartons

2. What does receiving count?

A Twenty-two cartons with matching item labels

C Two cartons with no labels

B Twenty cartons with wrong labels

D Twenty-two verified individual products

3. What has not been established?

A The matching item labels

C The original expected count

B Why two extra cartons arrived or whether an order change is approved

D The physical carton count

Answers and explanations: [page 85](#).

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 1 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

purchase order

Buyer document specifying ordered goods and quantities, often PO.

IN USE check the purchase order

inbound shipment

Goods arriving at a warehouse or receiving location.

IN USE identify the inbound shipment

expected quantity

Amount required by the reference order or record.

IN USE state the expected quantity

received count

Number physically counted on arrival, distinct from approval status.

IN USE report the received count

overage

Quantity above the expected or ordered amount.

IN USE flag an overage

carton

Outer package used as the counting unit here.

IN USE count the cartons

item label

Label identifying the goods or product reference.

IN USE compare the item label

item match

Correspondence between the observed and ordered product identity.

IN USE confirm the item match

quantity exception

Difference requiring review against the stated quantity.

IN USE report a quantity exception

supplier

Business providing the ordered goods.

IN USE contact the supplier

receiving clerk

Worker checking and recording incoming shipments.

IN USE brief the receiving clerk

inventory coordinator

Person coordinating stock records and related checks.

IN USE notify the inventory coordinator

Precision check

The expected count is twenty cartons and the observed count is twenty-two: an overage of two cartons. Matching item labels support product identity, not approval of the additional quantity or a change to purchase order 740.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 2 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

order line

Individual entry specifying an item and quantity on an order.

IN USE review the order line

packing slip

Supplier document describing the shipment contents.

IN USE compare the packing slip

delivery note

Document accompanying delivered goods and their descriptions.

IN USE check the delivery note

advance shipping notice

Electronic notice of expected shipment details, often ASN.

IN USE compare the advance shipping notice

quantity variance

Difference between expected and observed amounts.

IN USE quantify the quantity variance

supplier explanation

Supplier account of why a discrepancy occurred.

IN USE await the supplier explanation

order amendment

Authorized change to an existing purchase order.

IN USE request an order amendment

approval limit

Boundary of a person's authority to accept or change something.

IN USE respect the approval limit

acceptance status

Whether the goods or quantity have been accepted under the process.

IN USE clarify acceptance status

stock release

Authorization to make goods available for the relevant use.

IN USE distinguish stock release

invoice quantity

Number of units billed by the supplier.

IN USE verify the invoice quantity

reconciliation

Comparison of records and actual figures to explain differences.

IN USE begin quantity reconciliation

Precision check

Physical presence, receipt recording, quantity acceptance, payment, and stock release can be separate stages. Use the actual process and authority limits. Reporting an overage must not erase the original order or invent the reason for the additional cartons.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 1 of 2

IDENTIFY THE ORDER

"I am checking the shipment against purchase order 740."

STATE THE EXPECTATION

"The order expects twenty cartons."

STATE THE COUNT

"I have counted twenty-two cartons."

QUANTIFY THE EXCESS

"That is an overage of two cartons."

CONFIRM THE ITEM MATCH

"The item labels match the ordered item."

SEPARATE ITEM AND QUANTITY

"Matching labels do not resolve the quantity difference."

KEEP THE CAUSE OPEN

"The supplier has not explained the additional two."

AVOID AN ASSUMPTION

"I cannot call the extra cartons a free addition."

Over versus short

Over identifies excess quantity; short identifies a deficit.

Against

Names the order used as the basis of comparison.

Matching

Can describe product identity without describing quantity approval.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 2 of 2

FLAG THE EXCEPTION

"I will report the overage for review."

STATE THE AUTHORITY LIMIT

"I cannot approve an order change."

DISTINGUISH PAYMENT

"This count does not approve payment for the extras."

READ BACK BOTH FIGURES

"Twenty expected, twenty-two counted, item labels matching."

PRESERVE THE ORIGINAL FIGURE

"Keep twenty as the original ordered quantity."

AVOID A FALSE AMENDMENT

"The order has not been changed to twenty-two."

DISTINGUISH RELEASE

"The count alone does not authorize stock release."

CLOSE WITH THE OPEN QUESTION

"The extra quantity still needs an explanation and a decision."

Additional

Refers to the two beyond the original twenty.

Counted versus accepted

Physical observation is different from approval under the receiving process.

Has not explained

Leaves the cause unknown without accusing the supplier of deliberate action.

Choose the precise message

D Check your understanding

Circle one best answer for each item. Use the stated purpose and case facts, not the option that merely sounds most polite.

1. Which report includes all checked facts?

- A** PO 740 now orders twenty-two because they arrived.
- B** Two cartons arrived and all others are missing.
- C** Matching labels prove the supplier intended a free bonus.
- D** PO 740 expects twenty; twenty-two counted; item labels match.

2. Which figure describes the variance?

- A** No difference because labels match.
- B** Two cartons over the order.
- C** Two cartons short of the order.
- D** Twenty-two cartons over the order.

3. Which action exceeds Nia's authority?

- A** Asking for a supplier explanation.
- B** Approving the order change to twenty-two.
- C** Flagging the extra quantity.
- D** Stating that labels match.

4. Which conclusion does not follow from the labels?

- A** The additional quantity is approved for payment and release.
- B** The observed labels match the ordered item.
- C** Quantity review is still needed.
- D** The original order remains twenty cartons.

Answers and explanations: [page 85](#).

Two cartons over the order

E Conversations / turns 1-10

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once, without changing its form. Cover the answers at the end until you finish.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

quantity variance / overage / expected quantity / order amendment / supplier explanation /
received count / Stock release / approval limit / reconciliation / item match

- 01 **Nia:** Ben, can you check PO 740 with me? It calls for twenty cartons. I've counted twenty-two, and the item labels match.
- 02 **Ben:** So we're two over. I'll log an ¹ _____, with the product match noted separately. Have we heard from the supplier?
- 03 **Nia:** Not yet. Could these be extras from an earlier shortage? I don't have anything linking them to another order.
- 04 **Ben:** Then we need a ² _____. Don't put replacement stock in the note unless that is actually confirmed.
- 05 **Nia:** All right. I'll leave the ordered figure at twenty. I don't want my count to make it look as though we'd ordered twenty-two.
- 06 **Ben:** Keep the ³ _____ unchanged. The discrepancy would disappear on paper if we quietly increased the order to match the truck.
- 07 **Nia:** My receiving note can say twenty-two physically counted, but that sounds different from accepting twenty-two. Which wording do you need?
- 08 **Ben:** Say ⁴ _____ and make the unresolved acceptance clear. Use our actual status fields; don't select a status that approves more than you've checked.
- 09 **Nia:** The labels are right, at least. I'll put that beside the count instead of describing the whole delivery as correct.
- 10 **Ben:** Yes, the ⁵ _____ tells us which product arrived. It doesn't answer what to do with the two extra cartons.

The conversation, continued

E Conversations / turns 11-20

Continue with the word bank on page 10.

- 11 **Nia:** Can I amend the order once you've seen the count, or does that still go through the approval process?
- 12 **Ben:** An ⁶ _____ still needs authorization. Neither this call nor the matching labels gives you that authority.
- 13 **Nia:** Understood. I'll flag it to you. I haven't agreed to pay for the extras or made them available for use.
- 14 **Ben:** Good. ⁷ _____ remains a separate decision. Keep that separate from the quantity record so the next shift doesn't assume they're cleared.
- 15 **Nia:** For the summary, should I say plus two cartons, rather than simply twenty-two? Both numbers seem useful.
- 16 **Ben:** Include both. The ⁸ _____ is plus two, against twenty ordered and twenty-two counted. That makes the comparison clear.
- 17 **Nia:** I'll send that with PO 740 and the label match. The supplier's explanation is still the open question.
- 18 **Ben:** And retain your ⁹ _____ in the handoff. Someone reviewing the note needs to know what has not been authorized.
- 19 **Nia:** Read-back: twenty ordered, twenty-two counted, labels matching, two over. No explanation yet and no approved order change.
- 20 **Ben:** That's enough to start ¹⁰ _____. I'll take the discrepancy for review; don't describe it as resolved before we have the answer.

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 86

1. overage | 2. supplier explanation | 3. expected quantity | 4. received count | 5. item match | 6. order amendment | 7. Stock release | 8. quantity variance | 9. approval limit | 10. reconciliation

Flag another inbound overage

F Say it

Purchase order 851 expects twelve cartons. Receiving counts fifteen with matching item labels. The extra quantity is unexplained, and the clerk cannot approve an order change.

Complete the four gaps. Use each bank entry once.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

approved / fifteen / three / twelve

Clerk: "The order expects ¹ _____ cartons."

Coordinator: "The physical count is ² _____ cartons."

Clerk: "That is an overage of ³ _____ cartons."

Coordinator: "An order amendment is not ⁴ _____."

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 86

1. twelve | 2. fifteen | 3. three | 4. approved

Rehearse with a fixed script

1. Read the two quantities with their labels: twenty ordered and twenty-two counted.
2. Repeat the two-carton overage and the separate item-label match.
3. Read the closing handoff without changing the original order or approving payment.

WORKING ALONE

Read both roles, pausing for two seconds when the speaker changes. Repeat with the bank covered, then check any missed expressions.

The bin sign and stock disagree

A Read the situation

Read back similar item codes, distinguish location labels from product labels, and request a record check without substituting stock.

Picker Luis needs BK-14-B, blue folders, from bin A12. The bin sign names BK-14-B, but the stock in the bin is labelled BK-14-G, green folders. Inventory clerk Mei can check the putaway record. No stock move, bin-sign change, or substitution has been approved. The location mismatch does not prove why the green folders are there or establish where the blue folders are. Luis needs to report both complete codes and the location without picking the wrong color.

PEOPLE / Luis: Picker | Mei: Inventory clerk

SAY THE PART OF THE CODE THAT DIFFERS

Similar product codes can sound identical in a noisy warehouse. Repeat the full reference, then clarify the final letter in ordinary words. A confident location instruction should not override conflicting product information, and a discrepancy report should not become an accusation.

Briefing checks

Circle one answer in each item. Use the briefing.

1. Which item is required?

- A** BK-14-B, blue folders
- C** Either color of folder

- B** BK-14-G, green folders
- D** Any stock in A12

2. What is actually labelled on the stock in A12?

- A** BK-14-B, blue folders
- C** An approved substitute code

- B** No item code at all
- D** BK-14-G, green folders

3. What can Mei do next?

- A** Check the putaway record
- C** Declare the blue folders lost

- B** Approve a substitution automatically
- D** Move the green folders without authorization

Answers and explanations: page 87.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 1 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

item code

Identifier assigned to a product or variant.

IN USE read back the item code

stock-keeping unit

Internal identifier for a stock item or variant, often SKU.

IN USE verify the stock-keeping unit

product variant

Version of an item differing in a feature such as color.

IN USE distinguish the product variant

bin location

Identified storage position within the warehouse.

IN USE confirm the bin location

bin sign

Location display indicating assigned stock information.

IN USE compare the bin sign

stock label

Identifier attached to the actual goods or their packaging.

IN USE read the stock label

location mismatch

Conflict between assigned location information and observed stock.

IN USE report a location mismatch

putaway

Process of placing received goods in an assigned storage location.

IN USE check the putaway record

putaway record

Record of where goods were placed after receiving.

IN USE review the putaway record

location history

Record of stock movements involving a location.

IN USE examine the location history

item master

Central record of product information in the inventory system.

IN USE consult the item master

suffix

Final part of a code, here the letter B or G.

IN USE clarify the suffix

Precision check

BK-14-B is the requested blue-folder item; BK-14-G is the green-folder item observed at A12. The bin sign and stock label conflict. Neither their similarity nor the shared location authorizes substituting the green folders.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 2 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

color variant

Product version distinguished by color.

IN USE confirm the color variant

look-alike code

Identifier visually similar to another code.

IN USE distinguish look-alike codes

read-back

Repetition of information to verify accuracy.

IN USE request a full read-back

substitution

Use of a different item in place of the requested one.

IN USE avoid an unapproved substitution

stock move

Transfer of goods between locations.

IN USE request approval for a stock move

relabeling

Changing an existing label under the proper process.

IN USE distinguish relabeling from checking

assigned location

Storage position shown for an item in the relevant record.

IN USE verify the assigned location

observed stock

Goods actually seen at the location.

IN USE describe the observed stock

picking error

Selection of an incorrect item or quantity.

IN USE prevent a picking error

location correction

Authorized change to inaccurate location information.

IN USE request a location correction

SSCC

Serial Shipping Container Code: an 18-digit GS1 identifier for a logistic unit, such as one pallet.

IN USE verify the full SSCC

GTIN

Global Trade Item Number identifying a trade item, not a unique pallet shipment instance.

IN USE distinguish the GTIN from the SSCC

Precision check

The mismatch alone does not establish a bad putaway, a wrong sign, or a missing-blue-stock location. Read back both full codes and A12, then request the record check. Do not make an unapproved move or label change to force agreement.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 1 of 2

STATE THE REQUIREMENT

"I need BK-14-B, blue folders."

READ THE SIGN

"The bin sign says BK-14-B."

CLARIFY THE DIFFERING LETTER

"B as in blue, not G as in green."

AVOID A SUBSTITUTION

"Green folders are not the requested item."

NAME THE LOCATION

"I am checking bin A12."

READ THE STOCK

"The stock label says BK-14-G."

REPORT THE CONFLICT

"The sign and the actual stock label disagree."

ASK FOR THE RECORD

"Can you check the putaway record?"

B as in blue

Clarifies the code suffix using the relevant product color.

Says versus contains

The sign's wording and the location's physical contents are separate observations.

Assigned versus observed

A recorded location assignment is not proof of the goods currently present.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 2 of 2

KEEP THE CAUSE UNKNOWN

"I do not yet know why the green folders are here."

AVOID A FALSE CORRECTION

"No bin-sign change has been approved."

PRESERVE BOTH CODES

"Please keep BK-14-B and BK-14-G separate in the note."

DISTINGUISH CHECKING AND APPROVAL

"A record check is not permission to substitute."

KEEP LOCATION UNKNOWN

"We have not established where the blue folders are."

AVOID AN UNAPPROVED MOVE

"I will not move the stock based on a guess."

CONFIRM THE NEXT OWNER

"I will check the record for A12."

CLOSE THE CLARIFICATION

"The item mismatch remains open pending verification."

Similar versus identical

A one-letter difference can identify a different product variant.

Why versus where

The cause of the mismatch and the location of the correct stock are separate questions.

Check versus change

Looking at a record does not authorize a stock move or label amendment.

Choose the precise message

D Check your understanding

Circle one best answer for each item. Use the stated purpose and case facts, not the option that merely sounds most polite.

1. Which message is precise?

- A** The blue folders are definitely in the next bin.
- B** A12 sign says BK-14-B; stock says BK-14-G.
- C** A12 has the right item because the sign says so.
- D** The two codes mean the same thing.

2. Which clarification targets the code difference?

- A** BK-14, with the color suffix omitted.
- B** A12 as the requested product code.
- C** B as in blue, not G as in green.
- D** B as in blue, not B as in the bin location.

3. Which claim lacks evidence?

- A** A specific worker put the stock away incorrectly.
- B** The bin sign and stock label disagree.
- C** Mei can check the putaway record.
- D** No substitution is approved.

4. Which next step matches the authority supplied?

- A** Luis changes the bin sign immediately.
- B** The stock label is changed to match the bin sign.
- C** Mei checks the putaway record.
- D** Luis silently substitutes green folders.

Answers and explanations: [page 87](#).

The bin sign and stock disagree

E Conversations / turns 1-10

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once, without changing its form. Cover the answers at the end until you finish.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

observed stock / location mismatch / suffix / read-back / substitution / putaway record / stock move / verification request / bin sign / color variant

- 01 **Luis:** Mei, can you check A12? I need blue folders, BK-14-B, but the stock here says BK-14-G.
- 02 **Mei:** Let us separate the ¹ _____ from the stock label. What does the sign at A12 say, and what color are the folders you actually see?
- 03 **Luis:** The sign says B, blue. The stock says G, green. It's just that last letter, but it changes the item.
- 04 **Mei:** Then the ² _____ is different. You need B as in blue, while the stock label has G as in green.
- 05 **Luis:** I haven't picked the green ones. Can you check how they were put away before we go any further?
- 06 **Mei:** Good. An unapproved ³ _____ would not resolve the issue. I can check the putaway record to see what information we have for A12.
- 07 **Luis:** Could be the sign or the stock location. I don't know which, and I don't want to blame the last putaway without checking.
- 08 **Mei:** The ⁴ _____ is a useful next check. We should not assign a cause simply because the sign and the goods disagree.
- 09 **Luis:** Please don't mark the blue folders missing everywhere. I've only checked what is in A12.
- 10 **Mei:** Agreed. This is a ⁵ _____ at A12. We have not established where the blue folders are or why the green folders are in this bin.

The conversation, continued

E Conversations / turns 11-20

Continue with the word bank on page 19.

- 11 **Luis:** I'll include A12. Just sending the two codes wouldn't tell you where I found the mismatch.
- 12 **Mei:** Include a complete ⁶ _____: requested BK-14-B, sign BK-14-B, observed stock BK-14-G, location A12. That gives us the exact conflict.
- 13 **Luis:** That's right. Am I authorized to move anything or change the sign while you're checking?
- 14 **Mei:** No ⁷ _____ has been approved, and no sign change has been approved either. A check is not permission to make the records agree by changing something.
- 15 **Luis:** Understood. I'll leave the correction to the proper process and report the labels as they are.
- 16 **Mei:** Yes. The ⁸ _____ matters even when the rest of the code is identical. A familiar-looking reference is not enough to confirm the requested variant.
- 17 **Luis:** You'll check the record, then. I still don't have confirmed blue stock for this pick.
- 18 **Mei:** Correct. I own the ⁹ _____. I will check the putaway information without claiming that it has already located the blue folders.
- 19 **Luis:** Final read-back: A12 sign, BK-14-B blue; actual stock, BK-14-G green. Both codes stay in the note.
- 20 **Mei:** Exactly. Keep the ¹⁰ _____ distinct from the assigned location information. No substitution, move, or relabeling is approved by this discussion.

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 88

1. bin sign | 2. color variant | 3. substitution | 4. putaway record | 5. location mismatch | 6. read-back | 7. stock move | 8. suffix | 9. verification request | 10. observed stock

Clarify a different variant mismatch

F Say it

Bin C08 is signed for BX-20-R, red binders. The stock label reads BX-20-Y, yellow binders. Red is requested. Jo can check the putaway record; no move or substitution is approved.

Complete the four gaps. Use each bank entry once.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

BX-20-Y / BX-20-R / C08 / approved

Picker: "The requested item is ¹ _____."

Clerk: "The observed stock label is ² _____."

Picker: "The conflicting location is ³ _____."

Clerk: "No substitution is ⁴ _____."

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 88

1. BX-20-R | 2. BX-20-Y | 3. C08 | 4. approved

Rehearse with a fixed script

1. Read both complete item codes, then stress B as in blue and G as in green.
2. Repeat the sign, observed stock, and A12 location as three separate facts.
3. Read Mei's record-check commitment without claiming a substitute or stock move.

WORKING ALONE

Read both roles, pausing for two seconds when the speaker changes. Repeat with the bank covered, then check any missed expressions.

Six each is not six cases

A Read the situation

03

Resolve a unit-of-measure misunderstanding, calculate the product-specific case equivalent, and confirm the requested total.

Pick ticket S18 requests six each of a storage tray. For this item, one standard case contains six trays. Coworker Omar initially reads the request as six cases, which would contain thirty-six trays. Picker Asha clarifies that the requested six individual trays equal one standard case of this item. The correction does not establish the pack size of any other product, authorize a different quantity, or confirm that picking and dispatch have already been completed.

PEOPLE / Omar: Warehouse coworker | Asha: Picker

CORRECT THE UNIT BEFORE DEBATING THE NUMBER

Two coworkers can agree that the number is six and still prepare different quantities. State the unit attached to the order, the units per case for this item, and the resulting total. Make the correction about the shared record rather than the other person being careless.

Briefing checks

Circle one answer in each item. Use the briefing.

1. What does S18 request?

A Six individual trays

B Six cases of trays

C Thirty-six trays

D One individual tray

2. What is the stated pack size for this item?

A One tray per case

B Six cases per tray

C Thirty-six trays per case

D Six trays per standard case

3. How many standard cases equal the requested quantity?

A One

B Six

C Thirty-six

D Twelve

Answers and explanations: [page 89](#).

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 1 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

pick ticket

Record specifying items and quantities to select for an order.

IN USE read the pick ticket

unit of measure

Defined basis for expressing a quantity, often UOM.

IN USE confirm the unit of measure

each

Counting unit meaning one individual item.

IN USE order six each

case

Grouped package containing the stated number of items.

IN USE verify the case quantity

case pack

Number of individual items in one standard case.

IN USE confirm the case pack

pack size

Quantity contained in a particular packaged unit.

IN USE check the pack size

individual unit

One item counted separately from grouped packaging.

IN USE count individual units

requested quantity

Amount specified by the order or picking instruction.

IN USE preserve the requested quantity

case equivalent

Number of cases corresponding to a stated item quantity.

IN USE calculate the case equivalent

conversion factor

Numeric relationship used to convert one unit to another.

IN USE verify the conversion factor

per case

For each single case.

IN USE state six trays per case

total units

Complete number of individual items represented.

IN USE calculate the total units

Precision check

S18 requests six each, meaning six individual trays. Six trays per case makes that one case equivalent. Six cases would be thirty-six trays: thirty more than requested. The conversion applies only to this stated item and pack size.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 2 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

overpick

Selection of more units than requested.

IN USE prevent an overpick

underpick

Selection of fewer units than requested.

IN USE identify an underpick

full-case pick

Selection of a complete case under the picking process.

IN USE distinguish a full-case pick

each pick

Selection measured in individual units rather than cases.

IN USE clarify an each pick

inner pack

Smaller grouped package within a larger case, where used.

IN USE distinguish an inner pack

outer case

Larger package containing individual items or inner packs.

IN USE identify the outer case

product-specific conversion

Unit relationship that applies to the particular item.

IN USE use a product-specific conversion

order unit

Unit in which the order quantity is stated.

IN USE confirm the order unit

stocking unit

Unit used to record inventory for the relevant item.

IN USE check the stocking unit

quantity read-back

Repetition of both number and unit to verify accuracy.

IN USE give a quantity read-back

pick confirmation

Record that the actual required picking work has been completed.

IN USE distinguish pick confirmation

quantity correction

Amendment of an incorrect interpretation or recorded quantity.

IN USE explain the quantity correction

Precision check

Equivalent quantities do not by themselves establish a completed pick or authorize a particular handling method. Follow the actual order and picking process. For another item, check its unit definitions and pack size again rather than reusing six per case.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 1 of 2

03

NAME THE TICKET

"Let us check pick ticket S18."

EXPAND EACH

"That means six individual trays."

CALCULATE THE EQUIVALENT

"Six divided by six gives one case."

QUANTIFY THE OVERPICK

"That would be thirty trays more than requested."

READ NUMBER AND UNIT

"It requests six each."

STATE THE PACK SIZE

"This item has six trays per standard case."

CORRECT THE MISUNDERSTANDING

"Six cases would be thirty-six trays."

PRESERVE THE ORDER

"The requested total remains six trays."

Each

Functions as a unit and cannot be silently replaced with cases.

Per

States a ratio: six trays for one case.

Six divided by six

Converts requested individual units into the stated case equivalent.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 2 of 2

03

LIMIT THE CONVERSION

"This pack size applies to this item."

ASK FOR A READ-BACK

"Please repeat both the number and the unit."

CONFIRM THE AGREED INTERPRETATION

"One standard case contains the six requested trays."

AVOID CHANGING THE ORDER

"The ticket has not been increased to six cases."

AVOID A UNIVERSAL ASSUMPTION

"We must check the pack size for other products separately."

DISTINGUISH PACKAGING

"An outer case is not the same as one individual item."

SEPARATE CALCULATION AND COMPLETION

"We have clarified the quantity, not confirmed the pick."

CLOSE THE CORRECTION

"S18 is six trays in total, equivalent to one case for this item."

Six times six

Calculates the mistaken six-case total of thirty-six trays.

This item

Limits the conversion and prevents an unsupported rule for other products.

Equivalent versus completed

Correct arithmetic does not record that any picking work has occurred.

Choose the precise message

D Check your understanding

Circle one best answer for each item. Use the stated purpose and case facts, not the option that merely sounds most polite.

1. Which read-back is correct?

- A** One tray total, because one case is mentioned.
- B** Thirty-six cases, because both numbers are six.
- C** Six trays total, equivalent to one standard case of this item.
- D** Six cases total, because the ticket says six.

2. How many trays would six cases contain?

- A** Twelve
- B** One
- C** Thirty-six
- D** Six

3. How many excess trays would the mistaken six-case pick contain?

- A** Five
- B** Thirty
- C** Six
- D** Thirty-six

4. Which statement wrongly generalizes the pack size?

- A** Every product in the warehouse has six units per case.
- B** This item has six trays per case.
- C** Another item's case pack needs checking.
- D** S18 requests six individual trays.

Answers and explanations: [page 89](#).

Six each is not six cases

E Conversations / turns 1-10

03

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once, without changing its form. Cover the answers at the end until you finish.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

overpick / total units / quantity read-back / case pack / unit of measure / product-specific conversion / pack size / case equivalent / Pick confirmation / requested quantity

- 01 **Omar:** Asha, can you check this before I confirm the pick? S18 says six, and I was about to read that as six cases.
- 02 **Asha:** Read the ¹ _____ beside it. It's six each: six individual trays. The number alone isn't the instruction.
- 03 **Omar:** You're right; I skipped each. What is the pack for this tray? I need the conversion for this item, not the last one I picked.
- 04 **Asha:** Its ² _____ is six trays. One standard case contains the complete six-tray quantity on S18.
- 05 **Omar:** Then the case count is one. Six trays required, divided by six trays in a case. Have I got that the right way round?
- 06 **Asha:** Yes, the ³ _____ is one. Say six trays total as well, so nobody hears one and assumes you mean one tray.
- 07 **Omar:** If I'd taken six cases, I'd have thirty-six trays. I was multiplying the request instead of converting it.
- 08 **Asha:** Those would be the ⁴ _____ in the mistaken pick. Thirty-six is thirty above what this ticket asks for.
- 09 **Omar:** So the excess would be thirty trays, not five. Five is the difference in cases, using this particular case pack.
- 10 **Asha:** Exactly. An ⁵ _____ needs its unit stated too. Five extra cases and thirty extra trays describe the same excess here.

The conversation, continued

E Conversations / turns 11-20

03

Continue with the word bank on page 28.

- 11 **Omar:** I shouldn't use six per case for the folders on my next ticket, though. Their cartons look similar.
- 12 **Asha:** No. This is a ⁶ _____. The folder pack must come from the folder record, not the appearance of its carton.
- 13 **Omar:** What about another size of tray? Same product family, different item code. I'd check that separately as well.
- 14 **Asha:** Yes, confirm the ⁷ _____ for the exact item. A different variant may have a different quantity per case.
- 15 **Omar:** Let me try the radio message: S18, six storage trays each, one standard case equivalent. No pick confirmation yet.
- 16 **Asha:** That ⁸ _____ is clear. I'd say six individual trays rather than six trays each, which can sound awkward.
- 17 **Omar:** Six individual trays total. Thanks. We've corrected my reading, but I haven't said the stock has been picked or sent.
- 18 **Asha:** Right. ⁹ _____ belongs to the actual work record. The calculation cannot stand in for it.
- 19 **Omar:** I'll use the corrected quantity in the proper picking process. I won't change the order to six cases just because that was my first reading.
- 20 **Asha:** Good. The ¹⁰ _____ remains six trays. We caught the unit error before calling the pick complete.

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 90

1. unit of measure | 2. case pack | 3. case equivalent | 4. total units | 5. overpick | 6. product-specific conversion | 7. pack size | 8. quantity read-back | 9. Pick confirmation | 10. requested quantity

Convert a different pack size

F Say it

Pick ticket T29 requests twelve each of a folder. This item has four folders per standard case. A coworker misreads the request as twelve cases. No picking work has yet been confirmed.

Complete the four gaps. Use each bank entry once.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

forty-eight / three / four / folders

Picker: "The order requests twelve individual ¹ _____."

Coworker: "There are ² _____ folders per case."

Picker: "The correct case equivalent is ³ _____."

Coworker: "Twelve cases would contain ⁴ _____ folders."

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 90

1. folders | 2. four | 3. three | 4. forty-eight

Rehearse with a fixed script

1. Read six individual trays and one standard case equivalent.
2. Contrast thirty-six trays with six requested; say thirty excess trays, not five trays.
3. Read the pick-confirmation exchange without claiming the goods have been picked.

WORKING ALONE

Read both roles, pausing for two seconds when the speaker changes. Repeat with the bank covered, then check any missed expressions.

Reserve stock is not a delivery promise

A Read the situation

Quantify a pick-face shortfall, distinguish system reserve stock from available stock, and escalate against a stated cutoff.

Order D55 requires ten baskets, but picker Elena finds four at pick face B04. The system lists twelve baskets in reserve. Their allocation, availability, and replenishment timing have not been checked. Replenishment clerk Dev can review the situation. The order cutoff is 15:00, but no promise to complete the order by then is supported. Elena must report the six-basket shortfall without declaring a warehouse-wide stockout or assuming the reserve quantity is already available to D55.

PEOPLE / Elena: Picker | Dev: Replenishment clerk

GIVE THE SHORTAGE AND THE POSSIBLE SOURCE SEPARATELY

Saying we have twelve in reserve can sound like a promise that the order is covered. Pair the system quantity with the checks still needed. A useful escalation includes the required quantity, current pick-face quantity, location, order reference, and cutoff.

Briefing checks

Circle one answer in each item. Use the briefing.

1. How many baskets does D55 require?

A Four

C Six

B Twelve

D Ten

2. What is the shortfall at B04?

A Two baskets

C Four baskets

B Six baskets

D Twelve baskets

3. What is known about the twelve in reserve?

A They are all available for D55

C They guarantee completion by 15:00

B They have already replenished B04

D They are listed in the system; allocation and availability are unchecked

Answers and explanations: page 91.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 1 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

pick face

Location from which items are normally selected for orders.

IN USE check the pick face

reserve stock

Stock recorded in a storage area used to support picking needs.

IN USE check reserve stock

replenishment

Supplying stock to a picking location from another source.

IN USE request replenishment

short pick

Picking shortfall against the requested quantity.

IN USE report a short pick

order requirement

Quantity or specification needed to fulfill an order.

IN USE state the order requirement

pick-face quantity

Number of units currently present at the picking location.

IN USE confirm the pick-face quantity

shortfall

Amount needed beyond what is currently present.

IN USE quantify the shortfall

system quantity

Amount shown in the inventory system.

IN USE distinguish system quantity

allocation

Assignment of stock to a particular order or demand.

IN USE check stock allocation

reservation

Earmarking of inventory under the actual system process.

IN USE verify a stock reservation

available stock

Stock that is actually usable for the relevant demand under the process.

IN USE confirm available stock

on-hand balance

Recorded quantity held, not automatically free for a particular order.

IN USE examine the on-hand balance

Precision check

D55 needs ten baskets and B04 has four, so the location is six short. Twelve shown in reserve is a possible source to investigate, not proof that six can be allocated and replenished in time for 15:00.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 2 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

replenishment request

Request to review or supply stock for a picking location.

IN USE raise a replenishment request

replenishment task

Assigned work to move stock to the required location.

IN USE confirm the replenishment task

release status

Whether stock is authorized for the relevant use.

IN USE check release status

stockout

Absence of available stock at the relevant scope.

IN USE avoid an unsupported stockout claim

location shortfall

Insufficient quantity at a specified location.

IN USE report the location shortfall

order cutoff

Latest stated time relevant to processing the order.

IN USE state the order cutoff

fulfillment commitment

Promise to supply the required order under stated conditions.

IN USE avoid an unsupported fulfillment commitment

timing estimate

Provisional expectation for when work may be completed.

IN USE request a timing estimate

demand

Quantity needed by orders or other requirements.

IN USE review competing demand

FEFO

First-expire, first-out: prioritizing eligible stock by expiry rather than receipt date.

IN USE apply FEFO to eligible batches

availability check

Verification of stock usable for the specific requirement.

IN USE complete an availability check

remaining shelf life

Time between the relevant delivery date and expiry, assessed against customer requirements.

IN USE check remaining shelf life

Precision check

On-hand, reserved, allocated, released, and available may describe different inventory states. Use the actual system definitions. A short pick at one location does not prove a warehouse-wide stockout, and a replenishment request does not prove movement has occurred.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 1 of 2

IDENTIFY THE DEMAND

"D55 needs ten baskets."

STATE THE OBSERVED QUANTITY

"There are four baskets at B04."

STATE THE SYSTEM FIGURE

"The system lists twelve in reserve."

AVOID PROMISING THE RESERVE

"I cannot say those twelve are free for D55."

NAME THE LOCATION

"The pick face is B04."

CALCULATE THE SHORTFALL

"We are six short at the pick face."

PRESERVE THE UNCERTAINTY

"Allocation and availability have not been checked."

ASK FOR REVIEW

"Can the replenishment desk review the requirement?"

Six short

Measures the gap between ten required and four present.

Shown in reserve

Reports a system figure without asserting physical or allocation verification.

Free for

Informal wording for stock available to the specific order, not merely present.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 2 of 2

KEEP THE CUTOFF VISIBLE

"The order cutoff is 15:00."

LIMIT THE SHORTAGE CLAIM

"This is a B04 shortfall, not a confirmed warehouse-wide stockout."

CONFIRM THE NEEDED AMOUNT

"Six more baskets would meet the ten-basket requirement."

AVOID AUTOMATIC PRIORITY

"The cutoff needs review, not an invented priority approval."

AVOID A TIMING PROMISE

"We do not yet have a confirmed replenishment time."

SEPARATE REQUEST AND MOVEMENT

"The request does not mean the stock has moved."

PRESERVE THE ORDER REFERENCE

"Keep the review attached to D55."

CLOSE WITH NEXT CHECKS

"We need allocation, availability, and timing checked before promising fulfillment."

At B04

Limits the observed shortage to the named pick face.

By 15:00

Is not promised merely because fifteen hundred is the cutoff.

Request raised

Indicates a next action, not a completed replenishment.

Choose the precise message

D Check your understanding

Circle one best answer for each item. Use the stated purpose and case facts, not the option that merely sounds most polite.

1. Which escalation contains the essential facts?

- A** Twelve in reserve guarantees the order.
- B** The warehouse has no baskets anywhere.
- C** B04 has ten because the order requires ten.
- D** D55 needs ten; B04 has four; twelve shown in reserve are unchecked; cutoff 15:00.

2. How many additional baskets are needed at the pick face?

- A** Ten
- B** Twelve
- C** Six
- D** Four

3. Which claim is unsupported?

- A** The cutoff is 15:00.
- B** All twelve reserve baskets are available for D55.
- C** Allocation needs checking.
- D** Four baskets are at B04.

4. What must happen before a supported completion promise?

- A** Remove the cutoff from the message.
- B** Review stock allocation, availability, and replenishment timing.
- C** Repeat the system total confidently.
- D** Assume a request completes movement.

Answers and explanations: [page 91](#).

Reserve stock is not a delivery promise

E Conversations / turns 1-10

04

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once, without changing its form. Cover the answers at the end until you finish.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

fulfillment commitment / order cutoff / replenishment desk / allocation / pick face / replenishment request / location shortfall / availability check / system quantity / timing estimate

- 01 **Elena:** Dev, D55 is short at B04: ten baskets needed, four here. The cutoff is fifteen hundred.
- 02 **Dev:** You are six short at the ¹ _____. Does the system show any reserve stock for the same item, and has its availability been checked?
- 03 **Elena:** Twelve shown in reserve, but I haven't checked whether they're allocated. I can't say they're free for us.
- 04 **Dev:** Keep that distinction. The ² _____ is a possible source for review, not confirmation that the stock can be assigned and brought to B04.
- 05 **Elena:** Then I'll report ten needed, four here, six short, twelve in reserve unchecked. What else do you need?
- 06 **Dev:** Include the ³ _____ of 15:00 as well. That tells us why timing matters without claiming that replenishment can definitely meet it.
- 07 **Elena:** I'll include D55 and the exact item, so we don't get a different basket sent to B04.
- 08 **Dev:** Right. A ⁴ _____ needs the exact demand and location. Raising it does not mean a replenishment task has already been completed.
- 09 **Elena:** Could those twelve already be committed? I can see the balance, not the allocation detail.
- 10 **Dev:** That is why ⁵ _____ needs checking. Twelve on the screen does not necessarily mean twelve uncommitted baskets for D55.

The conversation, continued

E Conversations / turns 11-20

04

Continue with the word bank on page 37.

- 11 **Elena:** So I can't tell packing we'll have ten in time just because twelve appears on the screen.
- 12 **Dev:** Correct. We need an ⁶ _____ for this requirement, followed by a realistic timing assessment. The arithmetic alone does not supply those results.
- 13 **Elena:** I won't call it a warehouse-wide stockout, either. My count is only for B04.
- 14 **Dev:** Exactly. It is a ⁷ _____ of six baskets. We should not expand that into a claim that no baskets are available anywhere in the warehouse.
- 15 **Elena:** Six more at B04 would cover the quantity. We still need to know if those six can get here in time.
- 16 **Dev:** Yes. Any ⁸ _____ must follow the actual review. No confirmed replenishment time has been supplied so far.
- 17 **Elena:** Can you take the review? I'll keep the order and location together with the unanswered stock and timing questions.
- 18 **Dev:** I can review it at the ⁹ _____. Keep D55, ten required, four at B04, six short, twelve shown in reserve, and the 15:00 cutoff together.
- 19 **Elena:** Thanks. I'll tell packing you've taken the review, with no confirmed replenishment time or completion promise.
- 20 **Dev:** Good. A ¹⁰ _____ still needs support. We are taking the next review step, with allocation, availability, and replenishment timing still unresolved.

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 92

1. pick face | 2. system quantity | 3. order cutoff | 4. replenishment request | 5. allocation | 6. availability check | 7. location shortfall | 8. timing estimate | 9. replenishment desk | 10. fulfillment commitment

Report a different pick-face gap

F Say it

Order E66 needs fourteen bins. Pick face C05 has five. The system lists twenty in reserve, but allocation and availability are unchecked. The order cutoff is 16:30.

Complete the four gaps. Use each bank entry once.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

twenty / unchecked / nine / 16:30

Picker: "The pick face is short by ¹ _____ bins."

Clerk: "The system lists ² _____ in reserve."

Picker: "Allocation and availability remain ³ _____."

Clerk: "The order cutoff is ⁴ _____."

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 92

1. nine | 2. twenty | 3. unchecked | 4. 16:30

Rehearse with a fixed script

1. Read ten needed, four at B04, six short, and twelve shown in reserve.
2. Repeat allocation, availability, and timing as three checks still required.
3. Read the 15:00 cutoff without turning it into a replenishment promise.

WORKING ALONE

Read both roles, pausing for two seconds when the speaker changes. Repeat with the bank covered, then check any missed expressions.

The loose label belongs to another carton

A Read the situation

Interrupt a possible labeling error politely, compare carton and recipient references, and distinguish prevention from a completed error.

At packing station 3, packer Rosa has cartons C70 and C71. The screen for C70 names Harbor Shop. A loose label beside C70 names Hillside School and refers to C71. No label has been applied. Quality colleague Arun asks Rosa to pause the label match while both carton references and recipients are checked. The conversation prevents an unverified label application; it does not establish a completed mislabeling, a shipment departure, or permission to relabel either carton from memory.

PEOPLE / Arun: Quality colleague | Rosa: Packer

INTERRUPT THE ACTION, NOT THE PERSON

A short, specific pause request works better than a vague warning or accusation. Name the conflicting carton and recipient details immediately. If the label has not been applied, preserve that fact rather than describing a mistake as already completed.

Briefing checks

Circle one answer in each item. Use the briefing.

1. Who is named on the screen for C70?

A Harbor Shop

B Hillside School

C Both recipients

D No recipient

2. Which carton does the loose Hillside School label reference?

A An unknown unlisted carton

B C71

C C70

D Both C70 and C71

3. What is the current labeling status?

A C70 has already been mislabeled

B Both cartons have departed

C Relabeling has been completed

D No label has been applied

Answers and explanations: [page 93](#).

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 1 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

packing station

Work area used to prepare goods and packaging for dispatch.

IN USE identify the packing station

carton reference

Identifier distinguishing one packed carton from another.

IN USE verify the carton reference

shipping label

Label carrying shipment-routing and identification information.

IN USE match the shipping label

loose label

Label not yet attached to a package.

IN USE check the loose label

recipient

Intended receiving person or organization.

IN USE confirm the recipient

screen record

Information displayed in the relevant system view.

IN USE compare the screen record

label match

Verification that a label belongs to the intended carton.

IN USE pause the label match

label application

Attaching a label to the intended package.

IN USE verify before label application

mislabeling

Applying incorrect identifying information to an item or carton.

IN USE prevent mislabeling

reference cross-check

Comparison of identifiers across items and records.

IN USE complete a reference cross-check

adjacent carton

Nearby carton that may belong to a different shipment.

IN USE distinguish the adjacent carton

workstation mix-up

Confusion between materials or records at one work area.

IN USE report a workstation mix-up

Precision check

C70 corresponds to Harbor Shop on the screen. The loose Hillside School label references C71. Being physically beside C70 does not make it the correct label for C70. No label has yet been applied.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 2 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

shipping address

Destination details on the shipment record.

IN USE confirm the shipping address

order association

Link between a carton and the relevant order.

IN USE verify the order association

tracking number

Identifier used to follow a particular shipment.

IN USE check the tracking number

barcode

Machine-readable representation used to identify records or items.

IN USE verify the barcode

human-readable text

Printed characters a person can read without decoding equipment.

IN USE compare human-readable text

label printout

Printed label output before or after verification.

IN USE inspect the label printout

label reprint

Another print of a label under the actual process.

IN USE authorize a label reprint

record selection

Choice of the system record currently being viewed or used.

IN USE check the record selection

unapplied

Not yet attached to the carton.

IN USE keep the label unapplied

verification pause

Temporary pause to resolve a specific uncertainty.

IN USE request a verification pause

prevention

Action that stops an error before it occurs.

IN USE distinguish prevention from correction

shipment departure

Actual movement of a shipment away from the facility.

IN USE confirm shipment departure

Precision check

The necessary message identifies a potential mismatch and requests verification of both references. Do not describe it as a completed mislabeled shipment or guess a correction from the recipient names alone. Actual label production and application follow the site process.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 1 of 2

REQUEST A PRECISE PAUSE

"Please pause before applying that label."

IDENTIFY THE SCREEN

"The C70 screen names Harbor Shop."

STATE THE MISMATCH

"The carton reference and the loose label do not match."

CHECK BOTH CARTONS

"Let us verify C70 and C71 separately."

NAME THE STATION

"This is packing station 3."

IDENTIFY THE LOOSE LABEL

"This label names Hillside School and references C71."

AVOID A PROXIMITY ASSUMPTION

"Being beside C70 does not make it the C70 label."

PRESERVE APPLICATION STATUS

"No label has been applied yet."

Beside versus belongs to

Physical proximity does not establish record association.

Before applying

Places the intervention before an error is completed.

Yet

Preserves the fact that no label application has occurred.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 2 of 2

AVOID AN ACCUSATION

"I am flagging a possible mismatch before application."

ASK FOR THE FULL MATCH

"Check the carton reference and recipient together."

DISTINGUISH PREVENTION AND REPAIR

"This is a verification pause, not a completed relabeling."

READ BACK THE PAIRS

"C70 with Harbor Shop; the loose C71 label with Hillside School."

KEEP RECIPIENTS SEPARATE

"Harbor Shop and Hillside School are different recipients."

AVOID A MEMORY CORRECTION

"Do not relabel from memory."

KEEP DEPARTURE SEPARATE

"No shipment departure is established by this check."

CLOSE WITH THE REQUIRED CHECK

"Both carton-label associations need verification before application."

Both

Calls for checking each reference rather than assuming the other carton is correct.

Possible mismatch

Flags the risk without accusing someone of a completed mistake.

Recipient and reference

The name alone is not a substitute for checking the identifier.

Choose the precise message

D Check your understanding

Circle one best answer for each item. Use the stated purpose and case facts, not the option that merely sounds most polite.

1. Which interruption is most precise?

- A** Please pause: C70 names Harbor Shop, but this loose label names C71 and Hillside School.
- B** C70 has already been sent to Hillside School.
- C** Please reprint C70 before checking either record.
- D** C71 belongs to Harbor Shop because it is beside C70.

2. Which status report is accurate?

- A** Relabeling is complete.
- B** Both recipients have received their cartons.
- C** No label has been applied; both references need checking.
- D** C70 has already shipped with the wrong label.

3. What does the loose label's location prove?

- A** C71 has already departed.
- B** Only that it is beside C70, not that it belongs to C70.
- C** It must be the correct label for C70.
- D** The C70 screen is necessarily wrong.

4. Which next step preserves accuracy?

- A** Mark both cartons dispatched to clear the station.
- B** Verify both carton references and recipient associations.
- C** Swap labels from memory.
- D** Merge the two recipients into one record.

Answers and explanations: [page 93](#).

The loose label belongs to another carton

E Conversations / turns 1-10

05

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once, without changing its form. Cover the answers at the end until you finish.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

shipment departure / reference cross-check / screen record / order association / verification pause
/ Label application / workstation mix-up / prevention / loose label / carton reference

- 01 **Arun:** Rosa, stop a moment before you use that loose label. C70 says Harbor Shop on the screen; the label beside it says Hillside School.
- 02 **Rosa:** I haven't attached it. I'll check the ¹ _____ first. Does the loose one actually say C70?
- 03 **Arun:** No, it says C71. We're at station 3 with both cartons here. I think we're looking at two different recipient pairs.
- 04 **Rosa:** I see C71 on the ² _____, with Hillside School underneath. C70 on the screen is Harbor Shop.
- 05 **Arun:** Thanks for pausing. I caught it before anything went on, so we don't have a mislabeled carton to report at this point.
- 06 **Rosa:** Then it's a ³ _____, not a relabeling job. I'll keep the current status accurate.
- 07 **Arun:** Can you check both references, not just change the one in your hand? I don't want C71 left with an assumed match.
- 08 **Rosa:** Yes, the ⁴ _____ covers C70 and C71. I'll use their records rather than swap labels from memory.
- 09 **Arun:** The print could be perfectly right for C71 and still be wrong for C70. Being next to this carton doesn't make it its label.
- 10 **Rosa:** Exactly. The ⁵ _____ comes from the matching record. We need more than the names looking familiar.

The conversation, continued

E Conversations / turns 11-20

Continue with the word bank on page 46.

- 11 **Arun:** Read the two pairs back once, please. I nearly said Hillside for C70 myself because I'd just read the loose label.
- 12 **Rosa:** C70's ⁶ _____ names Harbor Shop. The loose C71 label names Hillside School. Neither label has been applied.
- 13 **Arun:** That's what I saw. We don't know why the loose label was there, and there's no need to guess who put it there.
- 14 **Rosa:** I'll report the possible ⁷ _____ with the exact references. A useful note doesn't need an accusation.
- 15 **Arun:** Right. Please don't write corrected wrong label. That would tell the next person a label was already attached and removed.
- 16 **Rosa:** I'll describe ⁸ _____ instead: mismatch spotted before application, both references being checked. That's the stage we're at.
- 17 **Arun:** Once the records are verified, label handling follows the normal process. I haven't checked either carton for dispatch readiness.
- 18 **Rosa:** Understood. ⁹ _____ and dispatch readiness are separate from identifying the two recipient names.
- 19 **Arun:** I'll leave the handoff as station 3, C70 Harbor Shop on screen, loose C71 Hillside School label, no labels applied.
- 20 **Rosa:** Agreed. We have no ¹⁰ _____ to record here. I'll finish the reference check before reporting any later stage.

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 94

1. carton reference | 2. loose label | 3. verification pause | 4. reference cross-check | 5. order association | 6. screen record | 7. workstation mix-up | 8. prevention | 9. Label application | 10. shipment departure

Pause another loose-label mismatch

F Say it

At station 5, the screen for carton D80 names Maple Clinic. A loose label beside it names Meadow Cafe and references D81. No label has been applied.

Complete the four gaps. Use each bank entry once.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

applied / D81 / Meadow Cafe / Maple Clinic

Colleague: "The D80 screen names ¹ _____."

Packer: "The loose label references ² _____."

Colleague: "Its recipient is ³ _____."

Packer: "No label has been ⁴ _____ yet."

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 94

1. Maple Clinic | 2. D81 | 3. Meadow Cafe | 4. applied

Rehearse with a fixed script

1. Read C70 with Harbor Shop and C71 with Hillside School.
2. Repeat the interruption and the statement that no label has been applied.
3. Read the cross-check request for both references, without swapping labels from memory.

WORKING ALONE

Read both roles, pausing for two seconds when the speaker changes. Repeat with the bank covered, then check any missed expressions.

Three staged, two on the manifest

A Read the situation

Compare staged goods with a dispatch record and report a cutoff risk without claiming departure or an approved correction.

Order L66 has three cartons staged in lane 2. Its dispatch manifest lists only two cartons. The carrier cutoff is 16:00, and the goods have not departed. Staging colleague Imani asks dispatch clerk Noah to investigate the missing carton entry. No cause or specific missing carton identifier has been established. The discrepancy concerns the recorded carton count, not a verified physically missing carton. A review request does not confirm a corrected manifest, carrier acceptance, or departure before cutoff.

PEOPLE / Imani: Staging colleague | Noah: Dispatch clerk

06

READY-LOOKING GOODS MAY STILL HAVE UNFINISHED RECORDS

Cartons in a staging lane can look ready to leave, but their physical position does not prove the dispatch record is complete. Name the lane, order, physical count, manifest count, and cutoff. Keep the record discrepancy separate from the actual movement status.

Briefing checks

Circle one answer in each item. Use the briefing.

1. How many L66 cartons are staged in lane 2?

A One

B Six

C Three

D Two

2. What does the manifest list?

A No cartons

B Two pallets

C Two cartons

D Three cartons

3. What is the actual departure status?

A All cartons have departed

B Only two cartons have departed

C Carrier acceptance is confirmed

D The goods have not departed

Answers and explanations: page 95.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 1 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

staging

Placing goods in a designated area ahead of a later process.

IN USE confirm staging status

staging lane

Designated area for grouped outgoing goods.

IN USE identify the staging lane

dispatch manifest

Record listing shipments or units included in a dispatch.

IN USE compare the dispatch manifest

staged count

Number physically present in the staging area.

IN USE verify the staged count

manifest count

Number recorded on the dispatch manifest.

IN USE state the manifest count

carton entry

Individual or counted carton record in the relevant document.

IN USE investigate a missing carton entry

record discrepancy

Difference between documented and observed information.

IN USE report a record discrepancy

carrier cutoff

Latest stated time for the relevant carrier process.

IN USE confirm the carrier cutoff

departure status

Whether goods have actually left the facility.

IN USE preserve departure status

carrier acceptance

Carrier's acceptance of goods under the actual process.

IN USE verify carrier acceptance

dispatch release

Authorization to proceed with the relevant outgoing shipment process.

IN USE await dispatch release

manifest correction

Authorized amendment to an inaccurate dispatch record.

IN USE confirm a manifest correction

Precision check

Three cartons are staged, but only two are listed. The manifest is one carton below the staged count. That is not evidence that a physical carton is missing, and the specific omitted carton reference has not been identified.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 2 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

shipment grouping

Association of cartons or items under one outgoing shipment.

IN USE verify shipment grouping

lane assignment

Designation of the staging lane for an order.

IN USE check the lane assignment

outbound order

Order being prepared for shipment from the facility.

IN USE identify the outbound order

loading status

Whether goods have been loaded, distinct from staging.

IN USE check loading status

departure confirmation

Evidence or record confirming goods have left.

IN USE obtain departure confirmation

missing entry

Record absent from the document, not necessarily a missing physical item.

IN USE investigate the missing entry

dispatch clerk

Worker coordinating outgoing records and shipment information.

IN USE contact the dispatch clerk

cutoff risk

Possibility that an unresolved issue affects the stated deadline.

IN USE flag the cutoff risk

reconciliation check

Comparison intended to explain and resolve inconsistent figures.

IN USE perform a reconciliation check

unverified cause

Explanation not established by the available evidence.

IN USE avoid an unverified cause

status distinction

Separation of stages that must not be treated as interchangeable.

IN USE preserve the status distinction

pending correction

Record amendment that has not yet been completed.

IN USE report a pending correction

Precision check

Staged, loaded, accepted by a carrier, and departed are separate statuses. The 16:00 cutoff gives urgency but does not prove completion before that time. Report the discrepancy for investigation without inventing an amendment or recording departure prematurely.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 1 of 2

IDENTIFY THE ORDER AND LANE

"L66 is staged in lane 2."

STATE THE DOCUMENT COUNT

"The manifest lists two cartons."

DISTINGUISH RECORD AND GOODS

"We are investigating a missing entry, not a confirmed missing carton."

ASK FOR INVESTIGATION

"Can dispatch check the missing carton entry?"

STATE THE PHYSICAL COUNT

"There are three cartons in the lane."

GIVE THE DISCREPANCY

"The manifest is one carton below the staged count."

KEEP THE DEADLINE VISIBLE

"The carrier cutoff is 16:00."

KEEP DEPARTURE ACCURATE

"The goods have not departed."

06

One below

Compares the manifest's two against the physical count of three.

Missing entry versus missing carton

Absence in a record is not the same as physical absence.

Staged

Identifies a preparation stage, not a completed carrier handover.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 2 of 2

AVOID A COMPLETION CLAIM

"The manifest has not been corrected yet."

KEEP THE CAUSE OPEN

"We do not know why the record differs."

SEPARATE LOADING AND DEPARTURE

"Loaded would not by itself prove departure."

READ BACK BOTH COUNTS

"Three staged, two listed, with departure still pending."

AVOID AN INVENTED IDENTIFIER

"We have not identified which carton reference is omitted."

SEPARATE STAGING AND LOADING

"Staged does not mean loaded."

AVOID A CUTOFF GUARANTEE

"I cannot promise departure before 16:00 from these facts alone."

CLOSE WITH THE NEXT OWNER

"Dispatch will investigate while the current status stays explicit."

Has not departed

Preserves the actual movement status explicitly.

Cutoff risk

Signals urgency without making an unsupported delivery commitment.

Which carton

Remains a question when only the count mismatch is known.

Choose the precise message

D Check your understanding

Circle one best answer for each item. Use the stated purpose and case facts, not the option that merely sounds most polite.

1. Which status update is accurate?

- A** The manifest is corrected because someone will check it.
- B** L66 has three staged in lane 2, two listed, and no departure yet.
- C** L66 has departed because the cartons are staged.
- D** One physical carton is definitely lost.

2. What is the known discrepancy?

- A** Three cartons missing from the warehouse.
- B** No discrepancy because the order number matches.
- C** One carton fewer on the manifest than in staging.
- D** One carton fewer in staging than on the manifest.

3. Which statement invents an outcome?

- A** The carrier cutoff is 16:00.
- B** Dispatch can investigate.
- C** No goods have departed.
- D** The goods will definitely depart before 16:00.

4. What should Noah investigate?

- A** The physical location of a carton assumed lost.
- B** The carrier's receipt assumed to cover three cartons.
- C** A replacement shipment assumed necessary.
- D** The missing carton entry and correct association with L66.

Answers and explanations: [page 95](#).

Three staged, two on the manifest

E Conversations / turns 1-10

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once, without changing its form. Cover the answers at the end until you finish.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

missing entry / dispatch manifest / cutoff risk / Staging / reconciliation check / manifest correction / departure confirmation / staged count / unverified cause / status distinction

06

- 01 **Imani:** Noah, there's a manifest discrepancy on L66. Three cartons in lane 2, but only two listed. Carrier cutoff is sixteen hundred.
- 02 **Noah:** I will check the ¹ _____. First, are we talking about three cartons physically present, rather than a system quantity you have not verified?
- 03 **Imani:** Three physically staged, yes. Nothing has departed. I'm comparing what's in lane 2 with the manifest.
- 04 **Noah:** Then the ² _____ is three and the document count is two. We should not describe that as a physically missing carton.
- 05 **Imani:** Please call it a missing entry, not a lost carton. The third carton is here with the other two.
- 06 **Noah:** That is the right ³ _____. A record can be incomplete while all the staged cartons are present. We still need to establish which entry is missing.
- 07 **Imani:** I haven't identified which carton reference is omitted yet. I have L66, lane 2, and the count difference.
- 08 **Noah:** I will investigate the ⁴ _____ without inventing an identifier. The check needs to connect the correct carton records with L66.
- 09 **Imani:** Can you flag sixteen hundred with it? Dispatch needs the deadline as well as the discrepancy.
- 10 **Noah:** I will flag the ⁵ _____ at 16:00. That gives the issue its timing context, but it does not mean I can promise a completed correction or departure by then.

The conversation, continued

E Conversations / turns 11-20

Continue with the word bank on page 55.

- 11 **Imani:** The order may look ready because it's staged. I don't want that turned into a departed status.
- 12 **Noah:** Yes. ⁶ _____ is not the same as loading or carrier acceptance, and neither of those should be assumed from their position in lane 2.
- 13 **Imani:** Have you corrected the record, or are you taking the check now? I need to pass on the right stage.
- 14 **Noah:** I am taking the investigation. A ⁷ _____ is not complete, and I should not tell you that the count has been fixed before the check.
- 15 **Imani:** I haven't established what caused the missing entry. It could be several things; I don't have evidence yet.
- 16 **Noah:** Keep the ⁸ _____ out of the factual conclusion. We can report the discrepancy accurately without assigning blame.
- 17 **Imani:** Read-back: L66, lane 2, three staged, two listed, cutoff sixteen hundred, nothing departed.
- 18 **Noah:** That is a clear ⁹ _____ to take forward. I will investigate the omitted entry while keeping those figures and the cutoff in view.
- 19 **Imani:** I'll name you for the investigation and keep it open. I won't tell the next shift the order has gone.
- 20 **Noah:** Correct. No ¹⁰ _____ exists here. Three staged, two listed, and the manifest question is still open while I investigate.

06

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 96

1. dispatch manifest | 2. staged count | 3. status distinction | 4. missing entry | 5. cutoff risk | 6. Staging | 7. manifest correction | 8. unverified cause | 9. reconciliation check | 10. departure confirmation

Report a different manifest gap

F Say it

Order M77 has five cartons staged in lane 4. The manifest lists four. The carrier cutoff is 17:00, and nothing has departed. Dispatch will investigate the missing entry.

Complete the four gaps. Use each bank entry once.

06

WORD + PHRASE BANK

departed / four / 17:00 / five

Colleague: "There are ¹ _____ cartons staged."

Clerk: "The manifest lists ² _____ cartons."

Colleague: "The cutoff is ³ _____."

Clerk: "No goods have ⁴ _____ yet."

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 96

1. five | 2. four | 3. 17:00 | 4. departed

Rehearse with a fixed script

1. Read three physically staged and two on the dispatch manifest.
2. Repeat lane 2, L66, and the 16:00 cutoff in one handoff.
3. Contrast a missing entry with a missing physical carton; then read no departure.

WORKING ALONE

Read both roles, pausing for two seconds when the speaker changes. Repeat with the bank covered, then check any missed expressions.

Unopened-looking is not ready for sale

A Read the situation

Confirm return identity, qualify an external observation, and refer condition review without releasing the item as saleable.

Returns intake worker Theo receives kettle K25, which matches its return reference. The packaging appears unopened, but the required condition review is still pending. Returns checker Mira owns that review. Theo cannot mark the kettle ready for sale. Colleague Hana needs a clear handoff separating reference matching, apparent packaging condition, review status, and release authority. No refund, functional check, product-safety finding, or saleable-stock decision has been completed in this scenario.

PEOPLE / Theo: Returns intake worker | Hana: Inventory colleague

07

A CAREFUL OBSERVATION CAN STILL BE USEFUL

Appears unopened reports what the packaging looks like without claiming that the item has never been used or is safe to sell. Confirm the return reference, name the reviewer, and preserve the pending status instead of letting a positive appearance substitute for the required decision.

Briefing checks

Circle one answer in each item. Use the briefing.

1. What has been matched?

- | | |
|---|--|
| A A completed refund and an invoice | B A safety certificate and a new sale |
| C A confirmed repair and replacement | D Kettle K25 and its return reference |

2. What does the packaging observation establish?

- | | |
|---|---|
| A All return checks are complete | B It appears unopened, without completing condition review |
| C The kettle is definitely unused and functional | D The item is certified safe for sale |

3. Who owns the pending review?

- | | |
|----------------------------|---|
| A The next customer | B No one |
| C Mira | D Theo with automatic sale-release authority |

Answers and explanations: [page 97](#).

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 1 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

return intake

Initial receiving and recording of returned goods.

IN USE complete return intake

return reference

Identifier linking goods to a specific return arrangement.

IN USE match the return reference

returned item

Product brought back through a return process.

IN USE identify the returned item

reference match

Correspondence between the item and the return record.

IN USE confirm the reference match

packaging appearance

Visible external state of the packaging.

IN USE describe packaging appearance

appears unopened

Looks unopened without proving past use or internal condition.

IN USE report appears unopened

condition review

Examination required to assess returned-item condition.

IN USE await condition review

returns checker

Person responsible for the relevant return examination.

IN USE name the returns checker

pending review

Status indicating the required examination is unfinished.

IN USE preserve pending-review status

saleable stock

Inventory approved as suitable for sale under the applicable process.

IN USE distinguish saleable stock

ready for sale

Status indicating required sale-release conditions have been met.

IN USE verify ready-for-sale status

release authority

Permission to approve an item for a particular use or status.

IN USE confirm release authority

Precision check

K25 matches the return reference, and its packaging appears unopened. Neither fact completes the condition review or proves unused, functional, safe, or saleable condition. Mira owns the review, and Theo cannot mark the kettle ready for sale.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 2 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

functional check

Examination of whether a product operates as required.

IN USE distinguish a functional check

product-safety finding

Established conclusion about relevant safety requirements.

IN USE avoid an unsupported product-safety finding

unused condition

State of not having been used, requiring appropriate evidence.

IN USE verify unused condition

intake observation

Fact or qualified impression recorded during initial receipt.

IN USE preserve the intake observation

review owner

Person responsible for completing the pending assessment.

IN USE identify the review owner

stock status

System or process classification of inventory condition and availability.

IN USE confirm stock status

restocking

Returning goods to the relevant inventory under the actual process.

IN USE clarify restocking authorization

disposition

Authorized decision about the next treatment of returned goods.

IN USE await the disposition

refund status

Whether a financial return to the customer has been approved or completed.

IN USE keep refund status separate

condition evidence

Information supporting a conclusion about item condition.

IN USE check condition evidence

review completion

Actual finishing of the required assessment.

IN USE confirm review completion

status release

Authorized change from a restricted or pending state.

IN USE distinguish status release

Precision check

Return identity, physical condition, financial remedy, and inventory status answer different questions. Preserve the actual site statuses and approval limits. This exercise does not instruct learners to test electrical goods, inspect product safety, or release a returned item.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 1 of 2

IDENTIFY THE RETURN

"This is kettle K25."

QUALIFY THE OBSERVATION

"The packaging appears unopened."

STATE THE REVIEW STATUS

"Condition review is still pending."

EXPLAIN YOUR LIMIT

"I cannot mark it ready for sale."

CONFIRM THE REFERENCE

"It matches the return reference."

AVOID A USE-HISTORY CLAIM

"I cannot confirm that the kettle has never been used."

NAME THE OWNER

"Mira owns that review."

SEPARATE IDENTITY AND CONDITION

"A reference match is not a condition approval."

07

Appears

Qualifies an observation instead of asserting a fully verified condition.

Unopened versus unused

Packaging appearance does not establish the complete use history of the item.

Matches

Answers identity, not functional condition or saleability.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 2 of 2

AVOID A FUNCTIONAL CLAIM

"No functional check is confirmed here."

KEEP FINANCE SEPARATE

"This handoff does not confirm a refund."

ASK FOR AN ACCURATE HANDOFF

"Please include the observation and the named reviewer."

DISTINGUISH ASSIGNMENT AND COMPLETION

"Mira owning the review does not mean it is finished."

AVOID A SAFETY CLAIM

"We have no established product-safety finding from this intake."

PRESERVE THE EXISTING STATUS

"Keep the review status pending until the required decision."

AVOID A FALSE RELEASE

"The item has not been approved as saleable stock."

CLOSE WITH THE NEXT STEP

"The next step is Mira's condition review."

Pending

Indicates the review is unfinished, not automatically failed or passed.

Owns versus completed

Responsibility for a review is not evidence of its outcome.

Ready for sale

Requires the actual applicable checks and authorization, not a visual impression alone.

Choose the precise message

D Check your understanding

Circle one best answer for each item. Use the stated purpose and case facts, not the option that merely sounds most polite.

1. Which handoff is accurate?

- A** K25 is unused and safe because the box looks closed.
- B** K25 is already released for sale.
- C** Mira has completed the review because she owns it.
- D** K25 matches its reference; packaging appears unopened; Mira's review is pending.

2. Which conclusion overstates the observation?

- A** The packaging appears unopened.
- B** Condition review remains pending.
- C** Theo lacks sale-release authority.
- D** The kettle is definitely functional and unused.

3. Who has the next defined task?

- A** Mira, to perform the condition review.
- B** Theo, to mark it saleable without review.
- C** Hana, to promise a refund.
- D** A customer, to decide the warehouse stock status.

4. Which status should not be claimed yet?

- A** Packaging appears unopened.
- B** Review pending.
- C** Ready for sale.
- D** Matched return reference.

[Answers and explanations: page 97.](#)

Unopened-looking is not ready for sale

E Conversations / turns 1-10

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once, without changing its form. Cover the answers at the end until you finish.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

Condition review / Refund status / reference match / Review completion / release authority / review owner / stock status / disposition / intake observation / functional check

07

- 01 **Hana:** Theo, is returned kettle K25 cleared for sale, or is the condition review still outstanding?
- 02 **Theo:** It has a ¹ _____ with the return record. The packaging appears unopened, but the condition review is still pending.
- 03 **Hana:** The box looks untouched. Are you saying it appears unopened, or that you've confirmed the kettle was never used?
- 04 **Theo:** It is an ² _____, not a confirmed history. I cannot say the kettle has never been used based only on how the packaging looks.
- 05 **Hana:** Then I won't call it ready for sale just because the box looks good. What has actually been completed?
- 06 **Theo:** Exactly. ³ _____ has not been completed. We have matched the identity, but that does not tell us the result of the required examination.
- 07 **Hana:** Who's taking the review? I need a named person for the handover, not just someone to look at it.
- 08 **Theo:** Mira is the ⁴ _____. She owns the condition review. Assigning that work to her does not mean we already have a decision.
- 09 **Hana:** Can you release it while we're waiting, or is that outside your authority?
- 10 **Theo:** No. I do not have that ⁵ _____. I cannot turn an intake observation into permission to return the kettle to saleable stock.

The conversation, continued

E Conversations / turns 11-20

Continue with the word bank on page 64.

- 11 **Hana:** And we haven't established that it works. Matching the return reference isn't a function test.
- 12 **Theo:** Correct. No ⁶ _____ is confirmed here. Nor does our conversation establish a product-safety finding or an approved sale-ready condition.
- 13 **Hana:** What about the refund? I shouldn't tell customer service it's approved from this warehouse note, should I?
- 14 **Theo:** Yes. ⁷ _____ is not established by this handoff. Identity, condition, inventory status, and a customer remedy are different questions.
- 15 **Hana:** I'll read the note back: K25 matched, packaging appears unopened, condition review with Mira, no sale release.
- 16 **Theo:** That keeps the ⁸ _____ accurate. It also avoids claiming that the item is either approved or rejected before the review provides its result.
- 17 **Hana:** So pending isn't the same as rejected, either. We don't have the condition decision yet.
- 18 **Theo:** Exactly. A ⁹ _____ still needs to follow the actual review process. We should not choose sale, rejection, repair, or another outcome from appearance alone.
- 19 **Hana:** I'll pass on exactly that, with Mira as owner. The next shift will know what remains outstanding.
- 20 **Theo:** Thank you. ¹⁰ _____ is still pending with Mira. K25 is matched to the return, but it has not been marked ready for sale.

07

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 98

1. reference match | 2. intake observation | 3. Condition review | 4. review owner | 5. release authority | 6. functional check | 7. Refund status | 8. stock status | 9. disposition | 10. Review completion

Hand over another pending return review

F Say it

Returned toaster T36 matches its return reference. Packaging appears unopened, but condition review is pending with Jo. Intake staff cannot release it for sale.

Complete the four gaps. Use each bank entry once.

07

WORD + PHRASE BANK

authorized / appears / Jo / T36

Intake: "The returned item is ¹ _____."

Colleague: "The packaging ² _____ unopened."

Intake: "The review owner is ³ _____."

Colleague: "Sale release is not ⁴ _____."

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 98

1. T36 | 2. appears | 3. Jo | 4. authorized

Rehearse with a fixed script

1. Read appears unopened with emphasis on appears.
2. Repeat the matched return reference and the condition review pending with Mira.
3. Read the distinction between pending, rejected, and ready for sale.

WORKING ALONE

Read both roles, pausing for two seconds when the speaker changes. Repeat with the bank covered, then check any missed expressions.

The recount agrees, the cause does not

A Read the situation

Transfer a verified count difference, distinguish completed recount from pending investigation, and preserve adjustment authority.

At shift change, inventory clerk Priya hands item T9 in B11 to evening clerk Sam for follow-up. The first cycle count found eighteen units; a completed recount also found eighteen. The system still shows twenty. The two-unit difference has no confirmed cause. Sam can review transaction history, but no stock adjustment is approved. Priya must make clear that recounting is already complete while cause investigation and any adjustment decision remain unfinished.

08

PEOPLE / Priya: Outgoing inventory clerk | Sam: Evening inventory clerk

DO NOT HAND OVER COMPLETED WORK AS IF IT WERE STILL MISSING

A useful handoff states what has already been verified as well as what remains open. Repeating the count may not answer a transaction-history question. Preserve both figures and the completed recount without implying that an agreed count gives automatic authority to adjust stock.

Briefing checks

Circle one answer in each item. Use the briefing.

1. What do both physical counts show?

A Eighteen cases with an unknown pack size

C Twenty units

B Eighteen units

D Two units

2. What does the system show?

A Twenty units

C Two units

B Eighteen units after an approved adjustment

D No item record

3. What is Sam's next task?

A State that theft is proved

C Perform the recount that has not yet occurred

B Review transaction history

D Approve an adjustment automatically

Answers and explanations: page 99.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 1 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

cycle count

Physical inventory check of selected stock on a recurring basis.

IN USE perform a cycle count

recount

Second count to verify a previous quantity.

IN USE confirm the recount

verified count

Quantity supported by the completed checking process.

IN USE report the verified count

system balance

Quantity currently recorded in the inventory system.

IN USE compare the system balance

count variance

Difference between counted and system quantities.

IN USE quantify the count variance

two-unit deficit

Count two units below the reference balance.

IN USE report a two-unit deficit

transaction history

Record of inventory receipts, issues, transfers, and adjustments.

IN USE review transaction history

receipt transaction

Record of stock received into the relevant inventory.

IN USE check the receipt transaction

issue transaction

Record of stock taken out for an order or use.

IN USE check the issue transaction

transfer transaction

Record of stock moved between locations or inventory categories.

IN USE review the transfer transaction

stock adjustment

Authorized change to recorded inventory to correct a difference.

IN USE request a stock adjustment

adjustment approval

Permission to make the relevant inventory correction.

IN USE await adjustment approval

Precision check

Both counts are eighteen, while the system shows twenty: the verified physical quantity is two units below the recorded balance. The recount is complete. The cause is not confirmed, and no adjustment has been approved.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 2 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

posting

Recording a transaction in the relevant system, possibly later than physical movement.

IN USE compare movement and posting times

unposted movement

Movement not yet reflected in the relevant records.

IN USE investigate a possible unposted movement

audit trail

Record allowing changes and actions to be traced.

IN USE preserve the audit trail

count sheet

Document recording an inventory count and its context.

IN USE retain the count sheet

item-location pair

Specific combination of product and storage position.

IN USE confirm the item-location pair

outgoing clerk

Worker transferring responsibility at the end of a shift.

IN USE brief the outgoing clerk

incoming clerk

Worker taking responsibility on the next shift.

IN USE identify the incoming clerk

completed check

Verification step already performed and recorded.

IN USE distinguish a completed check

pending investigation

Further inquiry whose result is not yet established.

IN USE hand over the pending investigation

cause finding

Supported conclusion explaining the discrepancy.

IN USE avoid an unsupported cause finding

handoff acknowledgment

Confirmation that the next person accepts the stated follow-up.

IN USE obtain a handoff acknowledgment

inventory integrity

Reliability of inventory records and their supporting evidence.

IN USE protect inventory integrity

Precision check

Transaction history can help explain a difference, but reviewing it is not the same as finding the cause or posting an adjustment. Preserve the original figures, item-location pair, and supporting record instead of overwriting the system merely to make it agree.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 1 of 2

NAME THE ITEM AND LOCATION

"This handoff concerns T9 in B11."

GIVE THE RECOUNT RESULT

"The completed recount also found eighteen."

QUANTIFY THE DIFFERENCE

"The count is two units below the system balance."

NAME COMPLETED WORK

"The recount is complete, not still pending."

GIVE THE FIRST COUNT

"The first count found eighteen units."

GIVE THE SYSTEM FIGURE

"The system still shows twenty."

KEEP THE CAUSE OPEN

"No cause has been confirmed."

NAME THE NEXT CHECK

"Please review the transaction history."

08

Also

Shows the recount agrees with the original eighteen-unit result.

Still

Indicates the system remains at twenty rather than claiming an adjustment occurred.

Below versus above

Gives the direction of the two-unit variance.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 2 of 2

ACCEPT OWNERSHIP

"I will take the transaction review."

AVOID AN INVENTED EXPLANATION

"An unposted movement is a possibility to check, not a finding."

PRESERVE THE EVIDENCE

"Keep both counts and the system figure in the record."

REQUEST A READ-BACK

"Please repeat the figures and the remaining task."

PRESERVE THE AUTHORITY LIMIT

"No stock adjustment is approved."

AVOID AN ACCUSATION

"The difference does not by itself prove theft."

SEPARATE ACKNOWLEDGMENT AND OUTCOME

"Taking the handoff does not resolve the variance."

CLOSE WITH THE CURRENT STATUS

"Eighteen verified, twenty recorded, cause unknown, adjustment unapproved."

08

Completed versus pending

Applies to separate tasks: recount complete, investigation pending.

Possible versus found

A suggested explanation is not a verified cause.

Will review

Assigns future work without implying review completion or adjustment approval.

Choose the precise message

D Check your understanding

Circle one best answer for each item. Use the stated purpose and case facts, not the option that merely sounds most polite.

1. Which handoff is accurate?

- A** T9 in B11: recount still missing and theft confirmed.
- B** T9 was adjusted to eighteen without approval.
- C** T9 has two physical units in total.
- D** T9 in B11: eighteen counted and recounted, twenty recorded, cause unknown.

2. Which task is already complete?

- A** The transaction-history review by Sam.
- B** The recount that also found eighteen.
- C** The cause investigation.
- D** The approved system adjustment.

3. What does the count variance establish?

- A** Two fewer physical units than the system balance.
- B** The cause is definitely an unposted issue.
- C** Theft by the outgoing clerk.
- D** Permission for any worker to change the balance.

4. Which next statement respects the approval limit?

- A** There is no need to retain the original system figure.
- B** I will review history; no adjustment is approved yet.
- C** I will change twenty to eighteen because I accepted the handoff.
- D** The recount automatically approves posting.

Answers and explanations: page 99.

The recount agrees, the cause does not

E Conversations / turns 1-10

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once, without changing its form. Cover the answers at the end until you finish.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

verified count / pending investigation / item-location pair / Adjustment approval / system balance / count variance / transaction history / audit trail / handoff acknowledgment / recount

08

- 01 **Priya:** Sam, I've got one count issue for handover: T9 in B11. Eighteen on the first count, eighteen on the recount, twenty in the system.
- 02 **Sam:** Is the ¹ _____ finished? I want to be sure I'm taking an investigation, not a request for a second count.
- 03 **Priya:** Finished, and it agreed at eighteen. The note needs both results, otherwise the next shift could think we're still waiting for that check.
- 04 **Sam:** I'll retain the ² _____ alongside twenty in the system. Have you established why they differ?
- 05 **Priya:** No. A movement or transaction might explain it, but I haven't checked enough to say that one does.
- 06 **Sam:** I'll take the ³ _____ review. We need the actual records before turning a possible explanation into a finding.
- 07 **Priya:** Also, no adjustment is approved. Two matching counts don't mean I had authority to replace the recorded twenty with eighteen.
- 08 **Sam:** Yes, ⁴ _____ is separate. Taking this handoff doesn't give me permission to post a change either.
- 09 **Priya:** Please keep B11 in the note. We haven't counted every location holding T9, so this isn't a total-stock statement.
- 10 **Sam:** I'll keep the ⁵ _____ explicit. T9 without B11 could send someone to the wrong balance.

The conversation, continued

E Conversations / turns 11-20

Continue with the word bank on page 73.

- 11 **Priya:** And say two below the recorded balance, not two remaining. There are eighteen physically here, not two.
- 12 **Sam:** Agreed. The ⁶ _____ is minus two units; the physical count is eighteen. I'll use both figures with their labels.
- 13 **Priya:** The cause stays unknown for now. I don't have evidence of theft or a particular person making an error.
- 14 **Sam:** That's important for the ⁷ _____. Keep the original figures and count results so we can trace what happened.
- 15 **Priya:** Can I name you for the transaction review in my handover? I'd like the next person to know who has that follow-up.
- 16 **Sam:** Yes. My ⁸ _____ covers that review. Mark it assigned to me, with the cause still unresolved.
- 17 **Priya:** Thanks. Read the current position back once, please, including the part that's already done and the part you're taking.
- 18 **Sam:** T9, B11: eighteen counted and recounted; ⁹ _____ twenty; cause unknown; adjustment unapproved. Recount complete, history review with Sam.
- 19 **Priya:** That's it. The physical check is complete, but the reason for the difference and any authorized correction are still outstanding.
- 20 **Sam:** I'll continue the ¹⁰ _____ from that point. I'll preserve the evidence rather than make the record agree before the explanation is established.

08

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 100

1. recount | 2. verified count | 3. transaction history | 4. Adjustment approval | 5. item-location pair | 6. count variance | 7. audit trail | 8. handoff acknowledgment | 9. system balance | 10. pending investigation

Hand over another verified count difference

F Say it

Item U8 in D03 was counted at twenty-seven units, and the completed recount agrees. The system shows thirty. The cause is unknown. Clerk Jo accepts transaction-history review; no adjustment is approved.

Complete the four gaps. Use each bank entry once.

08

WORD + PHRASE BANK

Jo / thirty / three / twenty-seven

Clerk: "Both counts give ¹ _____ units."

Colleague: "The system balance is ² _____."

Clerk: "The physical count is ³ _____ units below the system."

Colleague: "The transaction-history review belongs to ⁴ _____."

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 100

1. twenty-seven | 2. thirty | 3. three | 4. Jo

Rehearse with a fixed script

1. Read eighteen counted, eighteen recounted, and twenty recorded.
2. Repeat minus two as the variance, not the physical quantity.
3. Read Sam's next action while keeping the recount complete and adjustment unapproved.

WORKING ALONE

Read both roles, pausing for two seconds when the speaker changes. Repeat with the bank covered, then check any missed expressions.

Oldest is not always first

E More workplace conversations / 1-10

Apply a customer's remaining-shelf-life requirement before comparing eligible batches by expiry date.

Fictional eight-case order delivers 12 November 2026 and requires 30 days remaining. Date difference means expiry minus delivery. Available batches: A, 12 cases, received 1 October, expires 30 November; B, 10 cases, received 5 October, expires 31 December; C, 6 cases, received 8 October, expires 15 December. All other eligibility checks pass.

PEOPLE / Elena: Picker | Dev: Inventory coordinator

Use each bank entry once, without changing its form. Answers follow turn 20.

09

WORD + PHRASE BANK

batch B / remaining shelf life / batch split / ineligible / FEFO / eligible batches

- 01 **Elena:** Dev, I'm reviewing the eight-case order for November twelfth. Batch A arrived first and expires first. Shouldn't it be first in the proposed pick?
- 02 **Dev:** Check the customer's ¹ _____ requirement before ranking batches. This customer needs thirty days at delivery, calculated as expiry date minus delivery date.
- 03 **Elena:** November thirtieth minus November twelfth is eighteen days. So A is below thirty, even though it won't have expired on the delivery date.
- 04 **Dev:** Right. A is ² _____ for this order on that requirement. Don't call it expired or assume it needs writing off.
- 05 **Elena:** B expires December thirty-first, forty-nine days after delivery. C expires December fifteenth, thirty-three days after delivery. Both meet the minimum.
- 06 **Dev:** Then ³ _____, first-expire, first-out, puts C before B here. C expires sooner, despite having arrived three days after B.
- 07 **Elena:** So receipt order and expiry order aren't interchangeable. FIFO would compare when it came in; FEFO compares when it expires.
- 08 **Dev:** Exactly. Among these ⁴ _____, C is first. B arriving earlier doesn't move it ahead of C in this expiry-based proposal.
- 09 **Elena:** C has six cases, but the order needs eight. We use all six from C in the proposed allocation, then need two more.
- 10 **Dev:** Those two come from ⁵ _____. Six plus two gives eight, with both batches meeting the thirty-day minimum.

The conversation, continued

E More workplace conversations / 11-20

Continue with the word bank on page 76.

- 11 **Elena:** And B would have eight cases remaining after that allocation. A stays at twelve because none of it is proposed for this order.
- 12 **Dev:** Correct. Keep the ⁶ _____ visible: six C, two B. Writing just eight cases would lose the traceability of the proposal.
- 13 **Elena:** Would you describe A as rejected stock on the handoff? I can see how someone might read ineligible that way.
- 14 **Dev:** No. Say it fails this customer's remaining-life requirement for this delivery date. That does not decide its status for another order or authorize disposal.
- 15 **Elena:** If the delivery date moves, we need to calculate again rather than copy today's eligibility result. Less time could remain.
- 16 **Dev:** Yes. And our case assumes every other eligibility check passes. In an actual order, holds, reservations, product requirements, and customer terms still matter.
- 17 **Elena:** Let me read it back: A eighteen days, B forty-nine, C thirty-three. A fails thirty; C expires before B among the eligible batches.
- 18 **Dev:** That's the comparison. We've separated receipt dates, expiry dates, and the customer minimum instead of calling all three the oldest stock.
- 19 **Elena:** The proposed quantity is six C plus two B. This is a planning read-back, not a claim that anything has been picked or dispatched.
- 20 **Dev:** Agreed. Retain the delivery date and batch quantities with that proposal, then use the actual approval and picking process for any work.

09

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 101

1. remaining shelf life | 2. ineligible | 3. FEFO | 4. eligible batches | 5. batch B | 6. batch split

Check a later delivery

F Say it in a new situation

Six cases deliver 1 December 2026 with at least 21 days remaining. D expires 20 December and has 8 cases; E expires 10 January 2027 and has 5; F expires 28 December and has 4. All other checks pass. Use expiry minus delivery and earliest eligible expiry first.

Complete the four gaps. Use each bank entry once.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

nineteen / F / two / four

09

Picker: D has ¹ _____ days remaining, below the minimum.

Coordinator: The first eligible batch by expiry is ² _____.

Picker: Allocate ³ _____ cases from F.

Coordinator: Complete the order with ⁴ _____ cases from E.

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 101

1. nineteen | 2. F | 3. four | 4. two

Read, switch, repeat

1. Check the four answers and read the complete exchange aloud.

2. Switch roles. Read it again with the word bank covered.

3. Return to the extended conversation. Read turns 1-10, then switch roles for turns 11-20. Use the corrected expressions.

SOLO PRACTICE

Read both roles. Pause briefly at each change of speaker. Repeat any line that needed an answer check.

Two scans, one pallet identity

E More workplace conversations / 1-10

Distinguish a logistic-unit identifier from a trade-item identifier and lot, then report duplicate scan events without inventing receipt status.

Fictional receiving check: two physical pallets, P and Q, contain the same trade item and lot. Their complete SSCCs are confirmed distinct; staff say ending 0918 for P and ending 0925 for Q only as spoken shorthand. The scan-event log contains P twice and no Q. Neither receipt posting nor quantity acceptance is confirmed.

PEOPLE / Luis: Receiving clerk | Mei: Inventory clerk

Use each bank entry once, without changing its form. Answers follow turn 20.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

SSCC / batch or lot / complete identifier / Application Identifier / GTIN / duplicate scan

10

- 01 **Luis:** Mei, I've got two pallets here, P and Q, and two events in the scanner log. At first glance that looks like a complete pair.
- 02 **Mei:** Look at the ¹ _____, the Serial Shipping Container Code, in each event. Both events identify P, ending zero nine one eight.
- 03 **Luis:** Then the event count is two, but the log only contains one distinct pallet identity. Q ending zero nine two five isn't represented.
- 04 **Mei:** Exactly. That's a ² _____ of P in the event log. It does not establish what the receipt system posted.
- 05 **Luis:** Both pallets contain the same product and lot. Could I use the product number to show that Q is the second pallet?
- 06 **Mei:** No. A ³ _____, Global Trade Item Number, identifies the trade item. Matching product numbers don't make a missing pallet-identity event appear.
- 07 **Luis:** And the lot tells us which batch the goods came from. Two pallets can hold goods from that same batch.
- 08 **Mei:** Yes. The ⁴ _____ information matters for traceability, but it doesn't distinguish P from Q in this case.
- 09 **Luis:** On the GS1 reference sheet, I see parentheses around zero zero. Is that part of the eighteen-digit pallet identifier?
- 10 **Mei:** That's the ⁵ _____, often called AI. Zero zero says the following data is an SSCC; the SSCC itself has eighteen digits.

The conversation, continued

E More workplace conversations / 11-20

Continue with the word bank on page 79.

- 11 **Luis:** So AI zero zero means SSCC. AI zero one means GTIN, and AI ten means batch or lot. Different fields answer different questions.
- 12 **Mei:** Correct. And compare the ⁶ _____. Those four-digit endings are only our spoken shorthand, not enough to validate a label or prove uniqueness.
- 13 **Luis:** The briefing confirms the complete P and Q identifiers are different. I'll preserve both full references in the actual record.
- 14 **Mei:** Good. Say two pallets physically present, P scanned twice, Q absent from this scan-event log. Don't reduce that to two pallets received.
- 15 **Luis:** Should I report a duplicated receipt? Two events might sound like we've added P twice to inventory.
- 16 **Mei:** Not yet. We haven't checked receipt posting. A system might reject or handle repeated scans differently; the event log alone doesn't settle that.
- 17 **Luis:** And Q missing from the log doesn't mean Q is physically missing. It's here; its event is what I haven't found.
- 18 **Mei:** Exactly. Physical presence, scan history, and posted inventory are three different checks. Keep each status attached to its own evidence.
- 19 **Luis:** I'll refer the duplicate event and the absent Q event for verification, with the two complete SSCCs and their product and lot information.
- 20 **Mei:** That gives us the right problem to review. Follow the actual receiving process; don't invent a replacement identifier or manually double the quantity.

10

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 102

1. SSCC | 2. duplicate scan | 3. GTIN | 4. batch or lot | 5. Application Identifier | 6. complete identifier

Count identities, not beeps

F Say it in a new situation

Three physical pallets R, S, and T have different complete SSCCs but the same product and lot. The event log contains R, R, and S. Receipt posting is unchecked. Use the full identifiers for verification, not shortened verbal references.

Complete the four gaps. Use each bank entry once.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

two / T / unchecked / R

10

Clerk: The event log contains ¹ _____ distinct pallet identities.

Coordinator: The pallet absent from this event log is ² _____.

Clerk: The repeated pallet identity is ³ _____.

Coordinator: Posted inventory remains ⁴ _____.

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 102

1. two | 2. T | 3. R | 4. unchecked

Read, switch, repeat

1. Check the four answers and read the complete exchange aloud.
2. Switch roles. Read it again with the word bank covered.
3. Return to the extended conversation. Read turns 1-10, then switch roles for turns 11-20. Use the corrected expressions.

SOLO PRACTICE

Read both roles. Pause briefly at each change of speaker. Repeat any line that needed an answer check.

Counted when, recorded when?

E More workplace conversations / 1-10

Reconcile a physical count with a time-stamped balance using a verified movement, without double-posting an adjustment.

Fictional item W6, location C14: the 09:00 inventory snapshot is 100 units. A verified outbound movement takes 6 units at 09:05 but posts at 09:20. The physical count at 09:15 is 94. No other movements or differences occur through 09:20. Priya and Sam review the completed timeline, not operating instructions.

PEOPLE / Priya: Inventory clerk | Sam: Inventory reviewer

Use each bank entry once, without changing its form. Answers follow turn 20.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

variance / inventory adjustment / movement time / forward / cutoff time / posting time

11

- 01 **Priya:** Sam, the count sheet says ninety-four and the snapshot says one hundred. It looks six short, but the two records aren't from the same time.
- 02 **Sam:** Give me the ¹ _____ for each. The balance snapshot is nine o'clock, and the physical count is nine fifteen, correct?
- 03 **Priya:** Correct. Six units left C14 at nine oh five. We have the verified movement record, but it didn't post until nine twenty.
- 04 **Sam:** Then ² _____ is nine oh five. That's before the count, even though it is before the system entry as well.
- 05 **Priya:** So the nine o'clock snapshot still describes one hundred at its own point in time. It isn't automatically a bad count just because the later figure differs.
- 06 **Sam:** Right. Roll that balance ³ _____ to nine fifteen: one hundred minus six is ninety-four. That's the comparable expected physical quantity.
- 07 **Priya:** And ninety-four counted minus ninety-four expected gives zero. The apparent six-unit shortage came from comparing different times.
- 08 **Sam:** The reconciled ⁴ _____ is zero on these facts. Don't describe six as unexplained shrinkage when the verified movement accounts for it.
- 09 **Priya:** The physical movement was at nine oh five, the count at nine fifteen, and the entry at nine twenty. I should keep all three timestamps.
- 10 **Sam:** Yes. The ⁵ _____ belongs to the record update, not to when the goods left. Replacing one timestamp with another would distort the explanation.

The conversation, continued

E More workplace conversations / 11-20

Continue with the word bank on page 82.

- 11 **Priya:** By nine twenty the movement has posted. Since nothing else changed, the current balance should now be ninety-four too.
- 12 **Sam:** Exactly. A further minus-six ⁶ _____ would count the same reduction twice and take it to eighty-eight. The difference isn't a second loss.
- 13 **Priya:** Could we instead compare at nine o'clock by adding the six units back to the later physical count?
- 14 **Sam:** For the reconciliation calculation, yes: ninety-four plus six reconstructs one hundred at nine. Don't alter the actual ninety-four count entry to one hundred.
- 15 **Priya:** That distinction helps. A reconstructed comparison figure isn't a replacement for the observation made at nine fifteen.
- 16 **Sam:** Keep the original count, snapshot, movement evidence, and posting timestamp. They explain why the figures changed without overwriting the history.
- 17 **Priya:** Does an open cycle count always stop all stock movement? Someone might assume that nothing could have left between those two times.
- 18 **Sam:** Don't assume that. Site procedures and system settings differ. This case explicitly supplies a verified movement; real counting controls must be followed, not inferred from this example.
- 19 **Priya:** My handoff is W6 in C14, snapshot one hundred at nine, six out at nine oh five, count ninety-four at nine fifteen, posting at nine twenty.
- 20 **Sam:** And zero unexplained difference after reconciling to the same time. That explains this case; it isn't permission to move stock or post adjustments outside the actual process.

11

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 103

1. cutoff time | 2. movement time | 3. forward | 4. variance | 5. posting time | 6. inventory adjustment

Bring a receipt to the count time

F Say it in a new situation

Item X7: 14:00 snapshot 80 units. A verified receipt physically adds 12 at 14:05 and posts at 14:30. The 14:20 physical count is 92. No other movements occur through 14:30. Review after posting.

Complete the four gaps. Use each bank entry once.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

104 / 14:30 / zero / 92

Clerk: The balance reconstructed for 14:20 is ¹ _____ units.

Reviewer: The unexplained count variance is ² _____ .

Clerk: The receipt posting time is ³ _____ .

Reviewer: Adding another twelve after posting would wrongly show ⁴ _____ .

11

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 103

1. 92 | 2. zero | 3. 14:30 | 4. 104

Read, switch, repeat

1. Check the four answers and read the complete exchange aloud.
2. Switch roles. Read it again with the word bank covered.
3. Return to the extended conversation. Read turns 1-10, then switch roles for turns 11-20. Use the corrected expressions.

SOLO PRACTICE

Read both roles. Pause briefly at each change of speaker. Repeat any line that needed an answer check.

01 Briefing and language checks

Receiving against the expected shipment

A Briefing checks / page 4

1. What does purchase order 740 expect?

C. Twenty cartons

The purchase order specifies twenty cartons, which remains the comparison basis.

2. What does receiving count?

A. Twenty-two cartons with matching item labels

Receiving observes twenty-two cartons whose item labels match the ordered item.

3. What has not been established?

B. Why two extra cartons arrived or whether an order change is approved

The supplier has not explained the extras, and no order amendment is approved.

D Language checks / page 9

1. Which report includes all checked facts?

D. PO 740 expects twenty; twenty-two counted; item labels match.

The correct report preserves the expected count, observed count, and item-label match.

2. Which figure describes the variance?

B. Two cartons over the order.

Twenty-two observed minus twenty expected gives an excess of two cartons.

3. Which action exceeds Nia's authority?

B. Approving the order change to twenty-two.

The brief explicitly denies authority to approve an order amendment.

4. Which conclusion does not follow from the labels?

A. The additional quantity is approved for payment and release.

Identity information alone establishes neither payment approval nor stock-release permission.

01 Conversation answers

Receiving against the expected shipment

E Dialogue gaps

Pages 10-11

1. overage. Turn 2. Overage names the two cartons above the order's twenty, not the total quantity received.

2. supplier explanation. Turn 4. The supplier has not explained the extra cartons; a possible earlier shortage is not an established cause.

3. expected quantity. Turn 6. The expected quantity remains twenty, so the original order can still be compared with the physical count.

4. received count. Turn 8. Received count describes the physical observation of twenty-two cartons, without approving their acceptance or payment.

5. item match. Turn 10. The labels match the ordered product, but that does not resolve whether the additional quantity is accepted.

6. order amendment. Turn 12. Changing the purchase order requires authorization; Ben's review of a count does not itself provide that approval.

7. Stock release. Turn 14. Stock release is a separate authorization and is not established by reporting that cartons are physically present.

8. quantity variance. Turn 16. The variance is positive two cartons: twenty-two counted minus twenty ordered.

9. approval limit. Turn 18. Nia can report the discrepancy but cannot approve an order change, payment, or release through this conversation.

10. reconciliation. Turn 20. Reconciliation compares the order with the count and follows up the difference without erasing the original figures.

F Transfer conversation

Page 12

1. twelve

Clerk: "The order expects twelve cartons."

Twelve is the unchanged purchase-order quantity used as the reference.

2. fifteen

Coordinator: "The physical count is fifteen cartons."

Fifteen is the actual observed count at receiving in this scenario.

3. three

Clerk: "That is an overage of three cartons."

Fifteen minus twelve gives three cartons above the ordered amount.

4. approved

Coordinator: "An order amendment is not approved."

No authorized change has been granted by counting or reporting the extra cartons.

02 Briefing and language checks

Locating and identifying stock

A Briefing checks / page 13

1. Which item is required?

A. BK-14-B, blue folders

The pick requirement specifically identifies blue folders under BK-14-B.

2. What is actually labelled on the stock in A12?

D. BK-14-G, green folders

The stock labels identify green folders, conflicting with the bin sign.

3. What can Mei do next?

A. Check the putaway record

The brief authorizes a record check, not a move or substitute pick.

D Language checks / page 18

1. Which message is precise?

B. A12 sign says BK-14-B; stock says BK-14-G.

The precise message preserves both conflicting identifiers and the relevant location.

2. Which clarification targets the code difference?

C. B as in blue, not G as in green.

The final letter distinguishes the requested blue variant from the observed green variant.

3. Which claim lacks evidence?

A. A specific worker put the stock away incorrectly.

The observed mismatch does not identify a cause or responsible worker.

4. Which next step matches the authority supplied?

C. Mei checks the putaway record.

The available next step is verification, not an unapproved movement or record change.

02 Conversation answers

Locating and identifying stock

E Dialogue gaps

Pages 19-20

1. bin sign. Turn 2. Bin sign identifies the location's displayed assignment, which must be compared with the different stock label.

2. color variant. Turn 4. Color variant distinguishes blue folders from green folders; similarity of the other code characters does not make them interchangeable.

3. substitution. Turn 6. Substitution would replace the requested blue folders with green ones, which this location mismatch does not authorize.

4. putaway record. Turn 8. Putaway record may help establish what was placed in A12; it must be checked rather than assumed to prove a cause.

5. location mismatch. Turn 10. Location mismatch describes the observed conflict at A12 without establishing warehouse-wide absence or the correct item's location.

6. read-back. Turn 12. Read-back repeats the two full item codes and the bin so the verification request cannot collapse them into one.

7. stock move. Turn 14. Stock move is a separate action requiring authorization; the record-checking conversation does not approve it.

8. suffix. Turn 16. Suffix is the final B or G, the small code difference that identifies different folder colors.

9. verification request. Turn 18. Verification request assigns the record check while leaving the stock identity conflict and pick unresolved.

10. observed stock. Turn 20. Observed stock is the green BK-14-G actually seen, distinct from the bin's assigned blue-item description.

F Transfer conversation

Page 21

1. BX-20-R

Picker: "The requested item is BX-20-R."

BX-20-R identifies the requested red binders, not the yellow variant.

2. BX-20-Y

Clerk: "The observed stock label is BX-20-Y."

BX-20-Y is the label on the yellow binders physically present.

3. C08

Picker: "The conflicting location is C08."

C08 is the specific bin where the sign and stock disagree.

4. approved

Clerk: "No substitution is approved."

The mismatch does not authorize replacing red binders with yellow ones.

03 Briefing and language checks

Picking the right unit and quantity

A Briefing checks / page 22

1. What does S18 request?

A. Six individual trays

Six each means six individual trays, not six full cases.

2. What is the stated pack size for this item?

D. Six trays per standard case

The briefing defines one standard case as containing six trays for this item.

3. How many standard cases equal the requested quantity?

A. One

Six requested trays divided by six trays per case equals one case.

D Language checks / page 27

1. Which read-back is correct?

C. Six trays total, equivalent to one standard case of this item.

Six each divided by the six-tray case pack gives one case and six trays total.

2. How many trays would six cases contain?

C. Thirty-six

Six cases multiplied by six trays per case gives thirty-six trays.

3. How many excess trays would the mistaken six-case pick contain?

B. Thirty

Thirty-six trays minus the six requested trays gives thirty excess trays.

4. Which statement wrongly generalizes the pack size?

A. Every product in the warehouse has six units per case.

The supplied conversion applies to this tray item, not every warehouse product.

03 Conversation answers

Picking the right unit and quantity

03

E Dialogue gaps

Pages 28-29

1. unit of measure. Turn 2. The unit beside six is each, so the requested quantity is six individual trays rather than six cases.

2. case pack. Turn 4. This particular storage-tray item contains six trays per standard case, as stated in the briefing.

3. case equivalent. Turn 6. Six requested trays divided by six trays per case gives one case equivalent, without changing the requested total.

4. total units. Turn 8. Six cases multiplied by six trays per case produces thirty-six individual trays, not the six requested.

5. overpick. Turn 10. An overpick is a quantity above the request; here the proposed six cases would exceed demand by thirty trays.

6. product-specific conversion. Turn 12. The six-tray relationship belongs to this item; it does not establish a conversion for folders or other products.

7. pack size. Turn 14. Pack size is the quantity inside the actual item's package, which can differ between variants and products.

8. quantity read-back. Turn 16. The read-back preserves the six individual trays and one-case equivalent while keeping picking status explicit.

9. Pick confirmation. Turn 18. Pick confirmation records actual completed picking; a correct conversion alone does not establish that completion.

10. requested quantity. Turn 20. S18 still requests six individual trays; the conversation corrects an interpretation rather than amending demand.

F Transfer conversation

Page 30

1. folders

Picker: "The order requests twelve individual folders."

Each refers to individual folders, not full cases of folders.

2. four

Coworker: "There are four folders per case."

Four is the stated product-specific pack size in this new scenario.

3. three

Picker: "The correct case equivalent is three."

Twelve requested folders divided by four folders per case equals three cases.

4. forty-eight

Coworker: "Twelve cases would contain forty-eight folders."

Twelve cases multiplied by four folders per case would produce forty-eight folders.

04 Briefing and language checks

Reporting a short pick and replenishment need

04

A Briefing checks / page 31

1. How many baskets does D55 require?

D. Ten

Ten is the order requirement against which the pick-face quantity is compared.

2. What is the shortfall at B04?

B. Six baskets

Ten needed minus four present at the pick face gives six baskets short.

3. What is known about the twelve in reserve?

D. They are listed in the system; allocation and availability are unchecked

The system figure alone does not establish allocation, availability, or replenishment timing.

D Language checks / page 36

1. Which escalation contains the essential facts?

D. D55 needs ten; B04 has four; twelve shown in reserve are unchecked; cutoff 15:00.

The complete message retains the demand, observed quantity, uncertain source, and cutoff.

2. How many additional baskets are needed at the pick face?

C. Six

Ten required minus four present leaves a six-basket shortfall.

3. Which claim is unsupported?

B. All twelve reserve baskets are available for D55.

The reserve figure has not been checked for allocation or actual availability to this order.

4. What must happen before a supported completion promise?

B. Review stock allocation, availability, and replenishment timing.

Quantity in reserve alone does not establish usable stock or arrival at the pick face in time.

04 Conversation answers

Reporting a short pick and replenishment need

E Dialogue gaps

Pages 37-38

1. pick face. Turn 2. Pick face is B04, where four baskets are present against the order requirement of ten.

2. system quantity. Turn 4. System quantity is the twelve shown in reserve, not verified stock available to D55.

3. order cutoff. Turn 6. Order cutoff is fifteen hundred and must accompany the request without being turned into a completion promise.

4. replenishment request. Turn 8. Replenishment request starts review of supplying the correct stock to B04; it is not a completed movement.

5. allocation. Turn 10. Allocation identifies stock assigned to particular demand and must be checked before assuming the reserve is free.

6. availability check. Turn 12. Availability check establishes usable stock for the specific order rather than relying only on a reserve balance.

7. location shortfall. Turn 14. Location shortfall limits the observed problem to B04 and avoids an unsupported claim about all warehouse stock.

8. timing estimate. Turn 16. Timing estimate remains to be established; neither the reserve quantity nor the cutoff supplies a replenishment completion time.

9. replenishment desk. Turn 18. Replenishment desk is the responsible review point, not a guarantee that stock has been allocated or moved.

10. fulfillment commitment. Turn 20. Fulfillment commitment would promise the order outcome, which remains unsupported until stock and timing checks are complete.

F Transfer conversation

Page 39

1. nine

Picker: "The pick face is short by nine bins."

Fourteen required minus five present creates a nine-bin shortfall.

2. twenty

Clerk: "The system lists twenty in reserve."

Twenty is the displayed reserve balance, not verified available stock.

3. unchecked

Picker: "Allocation and availability remain unchecked."

The reserve balance has not been assessed for this specific order.

4. 16:30

Clerk: "The order cutoff is 16:30."

Sixteen thirty is the stated deadline, not a promised replenishment completion.

04

05 Briefing and language checks

Packing and label discrepancies

A Briefing checks / page 40

1. Who is named on the screen for C70?

A. Harbor Shop

The C70 screen names Harbor Shop as its recipient.

2. Which carton does the loose Hillside School label reference?

B. C71

The loose label explicitly identifies C71, not the nearby C70.

3. What is the current labeling status?

D. No label has been applied

The issue is caught before application, so completed-error wording is inaccurate.

D Language checks / page 45

1. Which interruption is most precise?

A. Please pause: C70 names Harbor Shop, but this loose label names C71 and Hillside School.

The specific pause identifies both conflicting reference-recipient pairs before application.

2. Which status report is accurate?

C. No label has been applied; both references need checking.

The discrepancy is detected before application and no shipment outcome is established.

3. What does the loose label's location prove?

B. Only that it is beside C70, not that it belongs to C70.

Physical proximity alone does not establish which record or carton the label belongs to.

4. Which next step preserves accuracy?

B. Verify both carton references and recipient associations.

The supplied next step is a reference cross-check, not an assumed correction or departure.

05 Conversation answers

Packing and label discrepancies

E Dialogue gaps

Pages 46-47

- 1. carton reference.** Turn 2. The carton reference identifies which carton the label belongs to; proximity to C70 is not sufficient.
- 2. loose label.** Turn 4. The unattached label identifies C71 for Hillside School, separate from the C70 screen record.
- 3. verification pause.** Turn 6. The work pauses before application while the conflicting references are verified, not after a completed labeling error.
- 4. reference cross-check.** Turn 8. Both carton identifiers and their recipient records need comparison; checking one does not validate the other.
- 5. order association.** Turn 10. The association links a carton to its relevant order or recipient record, not to whichever label is nearest.
- 6. screen record.** Turn 12. The screen for C70 names Harbor Shop; that information must remain separate from the loose C71 label.
- 7. workstation mix-up.** Turn 14. The arrangement creates a potential mix-up, without proving who caused it or that anything was shipped incorrectly.
- 8. prevention.** Turn 16. The check prevents a possible error before application; it is not evidence of repairing a completed mislabeling.
- 9. Label application.** Turn 18. Application has not happened yet and must follow the verified match and actual packing process.
- 10. shipment departure.** Turn 20. The label check supplies no evidence of shipment departure, and nothing has been described as dispatched.

F Transfer conversation

Page 48

1. Maple Clinic

Colleague: "The D80 screen names Maple Clinic."

Maple Clinic is the recipient associated with D80 on the screen.

2. D81

Packer: "The loose label references D81."

D81 is the different carton identified by the loose label.

3. Meadow Cafe

Colleague: "Its recipient is Meadow Cafe."

Meadow Cafe belongs to the loose D81 label, not the D80 screen.

4. applied

Packer: "No label has been applied yet."

The mismatch is identified before any label attachment occurs.

05

06 Briefing and language checks

Staging and dispatch status

A Briefing checks / page 49

1. How many L66 cartons are staged in lane 2?

C. Three

Three physical cartons are staged for L66 in the specified lane.

2. What does the manifest list?

C. Two cartons

The dispatch manifest records two cartons, one fewer than the staged count.

3. What is the actual departure status?

D. The goods have not departed

The briefing explicitly places all goods before departure, with the record issue unresolved.

D Language checks / page 54

1. Which status update is accurate?

B. L66 has three staged in lane 2, two listed, and no departure yet.

The accurate update separates the physical count, document count, and unfinished departure.

2. What is the known discrepancy?

C. One carton fewer on the manifest than in staging.

Two listed is one below the three physically staged cartons.

3. Which statement invents an outcome?

D. The goods will definitely depart before 16:00.

The deadline and review request do not establish a guaranteed departure outcome.

4. What should Noah investigate?

D. The missing carton entry and correct association with L66.

The supplied issue concerns a count mismatch in the dispatch record for L66.

06 Conversation answers

Staging and dispatch status

E Dialogue gaps

Pages 55-56

- 1. dispatch manifest.** Turn 2. Dispatch manifest lists two cartons and must be reconciled with the three physically staged for L66.
- 2. staged count.** Turn 4. Staged count is the three cartons physically present, distinct from the manifest's recorded two.
- 3. status distinction.** Turn 6. Status distinction separates the record mismatch from physical stock absence and from actual departure.
- 4. missing entry.** Turn 8. Missing entry is the document issue; its specific carton identifier has not yet been established.
- 5. cutoff risk.** Turn 10. Cutoff risk marks possible impact on the sixteen-hundred deadline without guaranteeing departure or acceptance.
- 6. Staging.** Turn 12. Staging places goods in a preparation area; it does not confirm loading, carrier acceptance, or departure.
- 7. manifest correction.** Turn 14. Manifest correction has not occurred merely because Noah accepts the investigation; the document still requires checking.
- 8. unverified cause.** Turn 16. Unverified cause remains unknown; the observed count difference does not identify an individual or system failure.
- 9. reconciliation check.** Turn 18. Reconciliation check compares the actual staged quantity with the manifest and seeks the correct missing association.
- 10. departure confirmation.** Turn 20. Departure confirmation is absent because the goods have not left; an accepted review task does not change that fact.

F Transfer conversation

Page 57

1. five

Colleague: "There are five cartons staged."

Five is the observed physical carton count in lane four.

2. four

Clerk: "The manifest lists four cartons."

Four is the document count, one below the staged quantity.

3. 17:00

Colleague: "The cutoff is 17:00."

Seventeen hundred is the deadline to include without guaranteeing departure.

4. departed

Clerk: "No goods have departed yet."

The stated physical movement status remains unchanged during the investigation request.

06

07 Briefing and language checks

Returns and stock status

A Briefing checks / page 58

1. What has been matched?

D. Kettle K25 and its return reference

The intake check connects the kettle to the correct return reference.

2. What does the packaging observation establish?

B. It appears unopened, without completing condition review

Appearance is the stated observation and does not establish the item's internal condition.

3. Who owns the pending review?

C. Mira

Mira is explicitly named as responsible for the condition review.

D Language checks / page 63

1. Which handoff is accurate?

D. K25 matches its reference; packaging appears unopened; Mira's review is pending.

The statement separates verified identity, qualified observation, and the unfinished review.

2. Which conclusion overstates the observation?

D. The kettle is definitely functional and unused.

External packaging appearance does not establish function or prior use.

3. Who has the next defined task?

A. Mira, to perform the condition review.

Mira is the named owner of the required pending assessment.

4. Which status should not be claimed yet?

C. Ready for sale.

Sale-ready status is unsupported because condition review and release approval remain incomplete.

07 Conversation answers

Returns and stock status

E Dialogue gaps

Pages 64-65

- 1. reference match.** Turn 2. Reference match confirms K25 belongs to the return record; it does not establish condition or saleability.
- 2. intake observation.** Turn 4. Intake observation reports the packaging appearance and does not verify the item's complete use history.
- 3. Condition review.** Turn 6. Condition review is the required next assessment, still unfinished despite the matching reference and apparent packaging state.
- 4. review owner.** Turn 8. Review owner identifies Mira as responsible for the assessment without implying she has already carried it out.
- 5. release authority.** Turn 10. Release authority to mark K25 ready for sale is not held by Theo and is not created by packaging appearance.
- 6. functional check.** Turn 12. Functional check would examine operation; no such completed check is supplied by this intake conversation.
- 7. Refund status.** Turn 14. Refund status concerns a separate financial process and is not established by matching the returned item.
- 8. stock status.** Turn 16. Stock status must preserve the pending review and absence of sale release rather than imply immediate availability.
- 9. disposition.** Turn 18. Disposition is the authorized decision about the returned item, still to follow the required condition review.
- 10. Review completion.** Turn 20. Review completion remains absent; the handoff names the owner but does not supply the assessment or its outcome.

F Transfer conversation

Page 66

1. T36

Intake: "The returned item is T36."

T36 is the toaster reference supplied for this new return.

2. appears

Colleague: "The packaging appears unopened."

Appears qualifies the visual observation without proving internal condition or past use.

3. Jo

Intake: "The review owner is Jo."

Jo is the named person responsible for the pending assessment.

4. authorized

Colleague: "Sale release is not authorized."

Intake staff lack authority to release the item before the required process.

08 Briefing and language checks

Inventory and shift handoffs

A Briefing checks / page 67

1. What do both physical counts show?

B. Eighteen units

The first count and completed recount both agree on eighteen units.

2. What does the system show?

A. Twenty units

The system balance remains twenty despite the verified physical count of eighteen.

3. What is Sam's next task?

B. Review transaction history

The recount is complete, and Sam can review the transaction history for the unexplained difference.

D Language checks / page 72

1. Which handoff is accurate?

D. T9 in B11: eighteen counted and recounted, twenty recorded, cause unknown.

The accurate message preserves both verified counts, the unchanged balance, and uncertainty about cause.

2. Which task is already complete?

B. The recount that also found eighteen.

The briefing explicitly states that the recount is complete and agrees at eighteen.

3. What does the count variance establish?

A. Two fewer physical units than the system balance.

The two-unit difference is arithmetic evidence, not proof of cause or authority.

4. Which next statement respects the approval limit?

B. I will review history; no adjustment is approved yet.

Reviewing records and accepting ownership do not authorize an inventory adjustment.

08 Conversation answers

Inventory and shift handoffs

E Dialogue gaps

Pages 73-74

- 1. recount.** Turn 2. The recount has already been completed and agrees at eighteen, so it is not the missing next action.
- 2. verified count.** Turn 4. Eighteen is supported by the first count and recount, while the recorded balance remains twenty.
- 3. transaction history.** Turn 6. The history is the next evidence source to review; it has not yet established a cause for the difference.
- 4. Adjustment approval.** Turn 8. Approval to change the inventory record remains separate from verifying the physical count or accepting the review.
- 5. item-location pair.** Turn 10. T9 and B11 together define the count being discussed; the finding does not cover all locations of T9.
- 6. count variance.** Turn 12. Eighteen counted minus twenty recorded gives a variance of minus two units, not a physical total of two.
- 7. audit trail.** Turn 14. Retaining both counts and the original system figure keeps the evidence traceable instead of replacing it with an assumed cause.
- 8. handoff acknowledgment.** Turn 16. Sam accepts responsibility for the history review, not a claim that it is already complete or the discrepancy resolved.
- 9. system balance.** Turn 18. The system balance is still twenty because no authorized adjustment has changed the recorded figure.
- 10. pending investigation.** Turn 20. The remaining investigation concerns the unexplained difference and transaction history, not a recount already completed.

F Transfer conversation

Page 75

1. twenty-seven

Clerk: "Both counts give twenty-seven units."

Twenty-seven is the verified physical quantity supported by the completed recount.

2. thirty

Colleague: "The system balance is thirty."

Thirty remains the recorded amount because no adjustment has been approved.

3. three

Clerk: "The physical count is three units below the system."

Thirty recorded minus twenty-seven counted gives a three-unit deficit.

4. Jo

Colleague: "The transaction-history review belongs to Jo."

Jo accepts the pending review without implying its completion or approving an adjustment.

08

09 Conversation answers

Oldest is not always first

E Extended conversation

Pages 76-77

1. remaining shelf life. Turn 2. Eligibility depends on days left at delivery, not simply whether the batch arrived or expires first.

2. ineligible. Turn 4. A has eighteen days remaining, below this customer's thirty-day requirement, although it is not yet expired.

3. FEFO. Turn 6. First-expire, first-out ranks the eligible stock by expiry; C expires before B, even though B was received earlier.

4. eligible batches. Turn 8. B and C both meet the customer minimum and all other stated checks; A fails the remaining-life requirement.

5. batch B. Turn 10. After using six eligible cases from C, two from B complete the eight-case requirement.

6. batch split. Turn 12. The proposed eight-case quantity consists of six C and two B; the batch identities must remain attached to the quantities.

F Transfer exchange

Page 78

1. nineteen

Picker: D has nineteen days remaining, below the minimum.

20 December minus 1 December is nineteen days, which fails the twenty-one-day requirement.

2. F

Coordinator: The first eligible batch by expiry is F.

F expires on 28 December, before eligible E on 10 January; D is ineligible.

3. four

Picker: Allocate four cases from F.

F has four eligible cases, leaving two of the six-case order still to cover.

4. two

Coordinator: Complete the order with two cases from E.

Six required minus four from F leaves two cases from E, which has forty days remaining.

Background reading: [Microsoft Learn: shelf life and customer sellable-day requirements](#). The conversation is an original fictional teaching case.

10 Conversation answers

Two scans, one pallet identity

E Extended conversation

Pages 79-80

1. SSCC. Turn 2. The Serial Shipping Container Code identifies a logistic unit; two events with P's same SSCC do not identify two different pallets.

2. duplicate scan. Turn 4. The same pallet identifier appears in both events, so the log repeats P rather than demonstrating a scan of Q.

3. GTIN. Turn 6. A Global Trade Item Number identifies the trade item, not a unique physical pallet instance containing that trade item.

4. batch or lot. Turn 8. A batch or lot groups relevant product units; it does not uniquely distinguish P from Q when both contain the same lot.

5. Application Identifier. Turn 10. The Application Identifier is a prefix defining the following data; AI 00 is separate from the eighteen digits of the SSCC.

6. complete identifier. Turn 12. The last four digits are only shorthand here; verification requires the complete identifier, whose distinctness is supplied in the case.

F Transfer exchange

Page 81

1. two

Clerk: The event log contains two distinct pallet identities.

R and S are two distinct identities; the repeated R event does not add a third.

2. T

Coordinator: The pallet absent from this event log is T .

T is physically present but has no event in the supplied log.

3. R

Clerk: The repeated pallet identity is R .

R appears twice in the event log, whereas S appears once.

4. unchecked

Coordinator: Posted inventory remains unchecked .

The event log does not establish whether repeated scans created, changed, or were rejected from a receipt posting.

10

Background reading: **GS1: logistic-unit identity, SSCC, and trade-item data**. The conversation is an original fictional teaching case.

11 Conversation answers

Counted when, recorded when?

E Extended conversation

Pages 82-83

1. cutoff time. Turn 2. The snapshot is a balance as of 09:00; it must not be compared as though it described the later 09:15 physical position.

2. movement time. Turn 4. The goods physically left at 09:05, before the count; the later posting time does not delay that physical change.

3. forward. Turn 6. To compare at 09:15, start from the 09:00 balance and subtract the six units that left before the count.

4. variance. Turn 8. At the same 09:15 time basis, both the adjusted reference quantity and the physical count are ninety-four, leaving zero variance.

5. posting time. Turn 10. 09:20 is when the six-unit movement reaches the system; it is not the physical movement time or count time.

6. inventory adjustment. Turn 12. The movement has already reduced the record to ninety-four; an extra minus-six adjustment would wrongly reduce it again to eighty-eight.

F Transfer exchange

Page 84

1. 92

Clerk: The balance reconstructed for 14:20 is 92 units.

The earlier eighty plus the twelve physically received before counting gives ninety-two.

2. zero

Reviewer: The unexplained count variance is zero .

Ninety-two counted matches the ninety-two expected on the same time basis.

3. 14:30

Clerk: The receipt posting time is 14:30 .

The system posting occurs at 14:30, distinct from physical receipt at 14:05 and counting at 14:20.

4. 104

Reviewer: Adding another twelve after posting would wrongly show 104 .

The posted balance is already ninety-two; another twelve would double-count the same receipt and show one hundred four.

11

Background reading: [Microsoft Learn: cycle counts, movements, and difference review](#). The conversation is an original fictional teaching case.

Find the move you need

Use these as precise language models. Replace details only when you know the actual facts, authority, and agreed conditions.

01 Receiving against the expected shipment

Identify the order: I am checking the shipment against purchase order 740.

Quantify the excess: That is an overage of two cartons.

Avoid an assumption: I cannot call the extra cartons a free addition.

Full phrase set: pages 7-8 | Dialogue: pages 10-11

02 Locating and identifying stock

State the requirement: I need BK-14-B, blue folders.

Read the stock: The stock label says BK-14-G.

Ask for the record: Can you check the putaway record?

Full phrase set: pages 16-17 | Dialogue: pages 19-20

03 Picking the right unit and quantity

Name the ticket: Let us check pick ticket S18.

State the pack size: This item has six trays per standard case.

Preserve the order: The requested total remains six trays.

Full phrase set: pages 25-26 | Dialogue: pages 28-29

04 Reporting a short pick and replenishment need

Identify the demand: D55 needs ten baskets.

Calculate the shortfall: We are six short at the pick face.

Ask for review: Can the replenishment desk review the requirement?

Full phrase set: pages 34-35 | Dialogue: pages 37-38

Keep the conversation productive

Use these as precise language models. Replace details only when you know the actual facts, authority, and agreed conditions.

05 Packing and label discrepancies

Request a precise pause: Please pause before applying that label.

Identify the loose label: This label names Hillside School and references C71.

Preserve application status: No label has been applied yet.

Full phrase set: pages 43-44 | Dialogue: pages 46-47

06 Staging and dispatch status

Identify the order and lane: L66 is staged in lane 2.

Give the discrepancy: The manifest is one carton below the staged count.

Keep departure accurate: The goods have not departed.

Full phrase set: pages 52-53 | Dialogue: pages 55-56

07 Returns and stock status

Identify the return: This is kettle K25.

Avoid a use-history claim: I cannot confirm that the kettle has never been used.

Separate identity and condition: A reference match is not a condition approval.

Full phrase set: pages 61-62 | Dialogue: pages 64-65

08 Inventory and shift handoffs

Name the item and location: This handoff concerns T9 in B11.

Give the system figure: The system still shows twenty.

Name the next check: Please review the transaction history.

Full phrase set: pages 70-71 | Dialogue: pages 73-74

Find a term and its context

The page number leads to the definition and a typical word combination. Repeated terms have separate entries when they serve different lesson contexts.

acceptance status clarify acceptance status	6
adjacent carton distinguish the adjacent carton	41
adjustment approval await adjustment approval	68
advance shipping notice compare the advance shipping notice	6
allocation check stock allocation	32
appears unopened report appears unopened	59
approval limit respect the approval limit	6
assigned location verify the assigned location	15
audit trail preserve the audit trail	69
availability check complete an availability check	33
available stock confirm available stock	32
barcode verify the barcode	42
bin location confirm the bin location	14
bin sign compare the bin sign	14
carrier acceptance verify carrier acceptance	50
carrier cutoff confirm the carrier cutoff	50
carton count the cartons	5
carton entry investigate a missing carton entry	50
carton reference verify the carton reference	41
case verify the case quantity	23
case equivalent calculate the case equivalent	23
case pack confirm the case pack	23
cause finding avoid an unsupported cause finding	69
color variant confirm the color variant	15

Find a term and its context

The page number leads to the definition and a typical word combination. Repeated terms have separate entries when they serve different lesson contexts.

completed check distinguish a completed check	69
condition evidence check condition evidence	60
condition review await condition review	59
conversion factor verify the conversion factor	23
count sheet retain the count sheet	69
count variance quantify the count variance	68
cutoff risk flag the cutoff risk	51
cycle count perform a cycle count	68
delivery note check the delivery note	6
demand review competing demand	33
departure confirmation obtain departure confirmation	51
departure status preserve departure status	50
dispatch clerk contact the dispatch clerk	51
dispatch manifest compare the dispatch manifest	50
dispatch release await dispatch release	50
disposition await the disposition	60
each order six each	23
each pick clarify an each pick	24
expected quantity state the expected quantity	5
FEFO apply FEFO to eligible batches	33
fulfillment commitment avoid an unsupported fulfillment commitment	33
full-case pick distinguish a full-case pick	24
functional check distinguish a functional check	60
GTIN distinguish the GTIN from the SSCC	15

Find a term and its context

The page number leads to the definition and a typical word combination. Repeated terms have separate entries when they serve different lesson contexts.

handoff acknowledgment obtain a handoff acknowledgment	69
human-readable text compare human-readable text	42
inbound shipment identify the inbound shipment	5
incoming clerk identify the incoming clerk	69
individual unit count individual units	23
inner pack distinguish an inner pack	24
intake observation preserve the intake observation	60
inventory coordinator notify the inventory coordinator	5
inventory integrity protect inventory integrity	69
invoice quantity verify the invoice quantity	6
issue transaction check the issue transaction	68
item code read back the item code	14
item label compare the item label	5
item master consult the item master	14
item match confirm the item match	5
item-location pair confirm the item-location pair	69
label application verify before label application	41
label match pause the label match	41
label printout inspect the label printout	42
label reprint authorize a label reprint	42
lane assignment check the lane assignment	51
loading status check loading status	51
location correction request a location correction	15
location history examine the location history	14

Find a term and its context

The page number leads to the definition and a typical word combination. Repeated terms have separate entries when they serve different lesson contexts.

location mismatch report a location mismatch	14
location shortfall report the location shortfall	33
look-alike code distinguish look-alike codes	15
loose label check the loose label	41
manifest correction confirm a manifest correction	50
manifest count state the manifest count	50
mislabeling prevent mislabeling	41
missing entry investigate the missing entry	51
observed stock describe the observed stock	15
on-hand balance examine the on-hand balance	32
order amendment request an order amendment	6
order association verify the order association	42
order cutoff state the order cutoff	33
order line review the order line	6
order requirement state the order requirement	32
order unit confirm the order unit	24
outbound order identify the outbound order	51
outer case identify the outer case	24
outgoing clerk brief the outgoing clerk	69
overage flag an overage	5
overpick prevent an overpick	24
pack size check the pack size	23
packaging appearance describe packaging appearance	59
packing slip compare the packing slip	6

Find a term and its context

The page number leads to the definition and a typical word combination. Repeated terms have separate entries when they serve different lesson contexts.

packing station identify the packing station	41
pending correction report a pending correction	51
pending investigation hand over the pending investigation	69
pending review preserve pending-review status	59
per case state six trays per case	23
pick confirmation distinguish pick confirmation	24
pick face check the pick face	32
pick ticket read the pick ticket	23
pick-face quantity confirm the pick-face quantity	32
picking error prevent a picking error	15
posting compare movement and posting times	69
prevention distinguish prevention from correction	42
product variant distinguish the product variant	14
product-safety finding avoid an unsupported product-safety finding	60
product-specific conversion use a product-specific conversion	24
purchase order check the purchase order	5
putaway check the putaway record	14
putaway record review the putaway record	14
quantity correction explain the quantity correction	24
quantity exception report a quantity exception	5
quantity read-back give a quantity read-back	24
quantity variance quantify the quantity variance	6
read-back request a full read-back	15
ready for sale verify ready-for-sale status	59

Find a term and its context

The page number leads to the definition and a typical word combination. Repeated terms have separate entries when they serve different lesson contexts.

receipt transaction	check the receipt transaction	68
received count	report the received count	5
receiving clerk	brief the receiving clerk	5
recipient	confirm the recipient	41
reconciliation	begin quantity reconciliation	6
reconciliation check	perform a reconciliation check	51
record discrepancy	report a record discrepancy	50
record selection	check the record selection	42
recount	confirm the recount	68
reference cross-check	complete a reference cross-check	41
reference match	confirm the reference match	59
refund status	keep refund status separate	60
relabeling	distinguish relabeling from checking	15
release authority	confirm release authority	59
release status	check release status	33
remaining shelf life	check remaining shelf life	33
replenishment	request replenishment	32
replenishment request	raise a replenishment request	33
replenishment task	confirm the replenishment task	33
requested quantity	preserve the requested quantity	23
reservation	verify a stock reservation	32
reserve stock	check reserve stock	32
restocking	clarify restocking authorization	60
return intake	complete return intake	59

Find a term and its context

The page number leads to the definition and a typical word combination. Repeated terms have separate entries when they serve different lesson contexts.

return reference match the return reference	59
returned item identify the returned item	59
returns checker name the returns checker	59
review completion confirm review completion	60
review owner identify the review owner	60
saleable stock distinguish saleable stock	59
screen record compare the screen record	41
shipment departure confirm shipment departure	42
shipment grouping verify shipment grouping	51
shipping address confirm the shipping address	42
shipping label match the shipping label	41
short pick report a short pick	32
shortfall quantify the shortfall	32
SSCC verify the full SSCC	15
staged count verify the staged count	50
staging confirm staging status	50
staging lane identify the staging lane	50
status distinction preserve the status distinction	51
status release distinguish status release	60
stock adjustment request a stock adjustment	68
stock label read the stock label	14
stock move request approval for a stock move	15
stock release distinguish stock release	6
stock status confirm stock status	60

Find a term and its context

The page number leads to the definition and a typical word combination. Repeated terms have separate entries when they serve different lesson contexts.

stock-keeping unit verify the stock-keeping unit	14
stocking unit check the stocking unit	24
stockout avoid an unsupported stockout claim	33
substitution avoid an unapproved substitution	15
suffix clarify the suffix	14
supplier contact the supplier	5
supplier explanation await the supplier explanation	6
system balance compare the system balance	68
system quantity distinguish system quantity	32
timing estimate request a timing estimate	33
total units calculate the total units	23
tracking number check the tracking number	42
transaction history review transaction history	68
transfer transaction review the transfer transaction	68
two-unit deficit report a two-unit deficit	68
unapplied keep the label unapplied	42
underpick identify an underpick	24
unit of measure confirm the unit of measure	23
unposted movement investigate a possible unposted movement	69
unused condition verify unused condition	60
unverified cause avoid an unverified cause	51
verification pause request a verification pause	42
verified count report the verified count	68
workstation mix-up report a workstation mix-up	41

Original cases. Clear boundaries.

These are original fictional teaching conversations, not transcripts of real workers. Names, figures, organizations, and incidents are invented. Sources support terminology and communication aims, not the fictional results or an endorsement of this book.

[1] US Bureau of Labor Statistics. Material Recording Clerks.

[Open the original source](#)

Occupational context for shipment records, package checks, stock information, and inventory discrepancies. All teaching cases and conversations are original and fictional. Checked 10 October 2026.

[2] Microsoft Learn. Set Up Unit Sequence Groups.

[Open the original source](#)

Terminology background for product-specific relationships between individual units, boxes, and pallets. The book does not teach Microsoft system setup or prescribe a universal pack size. Checked 10 October 2026.

[3] Microsoft Learn. Cycle Counting.

[Open the original source](#)

Context for distinguishing physical inventory counts from review of differences. Fictional approval limits and handoffs are not instructions for operating a particular warehouse system. Checked 10 October 2026.

[4] Occupational Safety and Health Administration. Warehousing: Hazards and Solutions.

[Open the original source](#)

Safety context for separating communication practice from actual site training, equipment use, and handling procedures. The dialogues do not provide operational safety certification. Checked 10 October 2026.

Phil Stilwell

© 2026 Phil Stilwell. All rights reserved.

No part of this publication may be reproduced, stored in a retrieval system, or transmitted in any form or by any means without prior written permission from the author, except as permitted by law.

All orders, goods, locations, quantities, workers, times, and decisions are fictional. This book teaches workplace English, not equipment operation, manual handling, warehouse-system configuration, product-safety inspection, or inventory authorization. Follow actual site procedures, training, safety controls, product requirements, and approval limits. The dialogues do not authorize stock movement, relabeling, release for sale, shipment, or record adjustment. Do not enter restricted areas or operate equipment based on a language exercise.

English Ladder | English for Work | 2026 edition. The B2-C1 range is an editorial study recommendation, not a proficiency certification.

[Open the matching English Ladder course](#)